

CONFERENCE '73

Theme:

'Responsibility—Our Expression of Gratitude'

Twenty-Third

Annual Meeting

of the

General Service Conference

(U.S. and Canada)

of

Alcoholics Anonymous

Hotel Roosevelt

New York

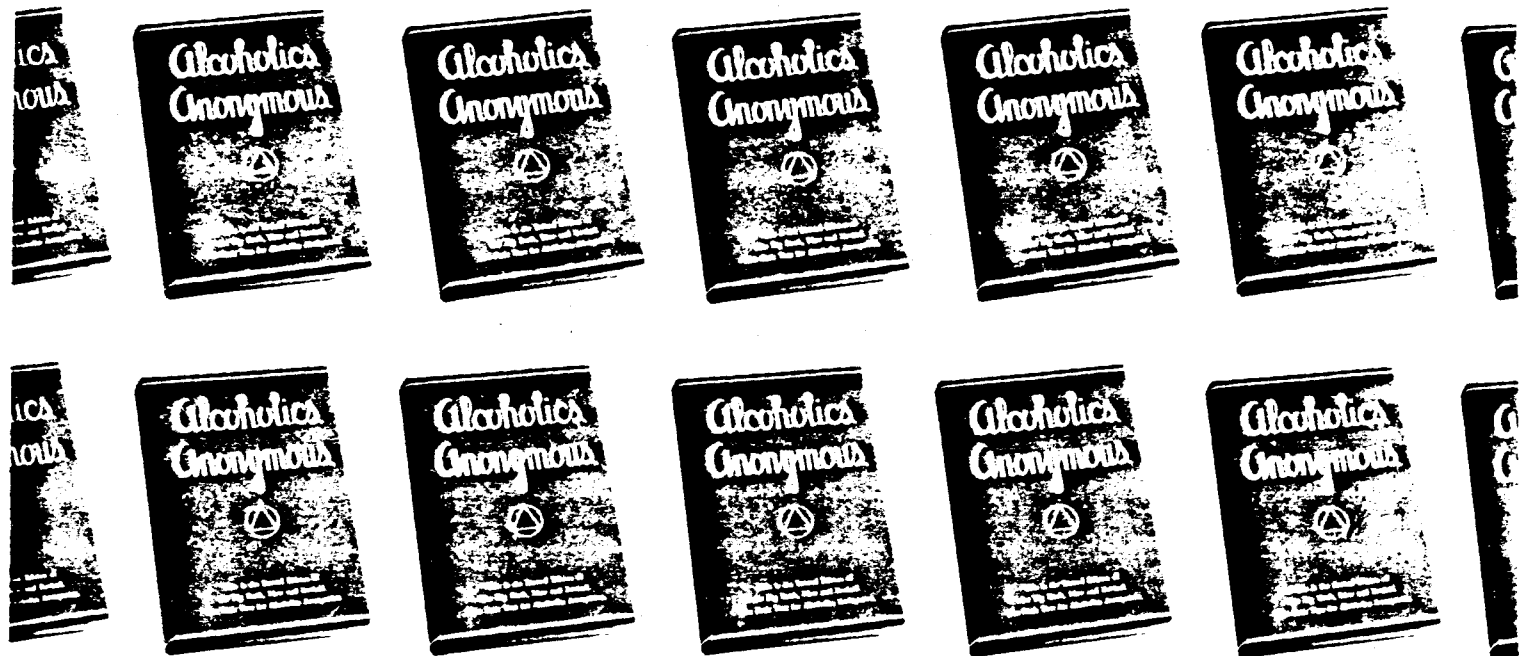
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Conference-Month Milestone—Millionth Big Book

At the White House on April 16, Dr. John L. Norris, nonalcoholic chairman of the A.A. General Service Board, presented to President Nixon the one-millionth copy of "Alcoholics Anonymous."

One million Big Books! You'd need a bookshelf 27.62 miles long to hold them. Stand the bookshelf on end, and the stack of 1,000,000 Big Books would be from 70 to 237 times as tall as the tallest structures on this continent. To measure up to 1,000,000 Big Books, it would take more than 70 KTHI-TV towers (Fargo, N.Dak.) balanced atop each other. Or more than . . .

100 Sears Towers (Chicago)
107 World Trade Centers (New York)
116 Empire State Buildings (New York)
131 John Hancock Centers (Chicago)
173 U.S. Steel Buildings (Pittsburgh)
187 Bank of America Buildings (San Francisco)

190 Imperial Bank of Commerce Buildings (Toronto)
194 Prudential Towers (Boston)
205 Terminal Towers (Cleveland)
208 One Shell Plaza Buildings (Houston)
218 Atlantic Richfield Plaza Buildings (Los Angeles)
233 Stock Exchange Towers (Montreal)
237 First National Bank Buildings (Dallas)

The calculations were done with the aid of a World Almanac and a Big Book of the present size, 1-3/4 inches thick. The original volume, printed in 1939, was nearly 2 inches thick, because Mr. Edward Blackwell of Cornwall Press (who printed the thing mostly on faith, without much hope he'd ever get paid) used . . . But let Bill W. tell the story ("A.A. Comes of Age," p. 170):

We fixed the retail price of the book at \$3.50. This figure was the result of long and heated arguments. . . . As a consolation to the contestants, we directed Mr. Blackwell to do the job on the thickest

paper in his shop. The original volume proved to be so bulky that it became known as the "Big Book." Of course, the idea was to convince the alcoholic purchaser that he was indeed getting his money's worth!

The very first print order of Big Books was for 4,800 copies, and it took A.A. three years to pay off the bill, according to Dennis Manders, nonalcoholic controller at G.S.O.

Today, Big Books are ordered to be printed in quantities of 100,000 copies, he noted, representing about a 12-month supply in the recent past. This requires 80 tons of paper—or four freight-car loads—"sobriety by the carload," Dennis said.

But at the rate of sales set in March (9,109 books!), the next print order will have to be for 150,000 copies, the controller said, with a big grin. Printers' bills to G.S.O. now get paid within ten days, he added.

An A.A. member may order a copy of this report through his G.S.R. or other group officer. Traditionally, all members have the right of access to information about all phases of A.A.'s General Services. This report is "confidential" only because in it certain members must be identified by name. The "confidential" designation protects the personal anonymity of such members at the public level.

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An Intensive A.A. Experience

From the welcome by John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris, chairman of the Conference (as chairman of the G.S. Board), to the "Our Father" led by Lois W., Bill's widow, which closed the postdinner A.A. meeting—Tuesday, April 24, opening day of the 1973 Conference, was an intensive A.A. experience for the Panels 22 and 23 delegates (representing U.S. and Canadian A.A. groups) and other members of the Conference (see p. 41).

Two hundred sixty-five—including Conference members' spouses, former trustees, employees and volunteers from Al-Anon Family Group Headquarters, the Grapevine, and G.S.O., hospitality and Trustees' committee members—attended the opening dinner. Fourteen G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members gave three-minute A.A. talks, and Jim. O., Panel 22, New Mexico delegate, was the main speaker.

Jim said that, despite his Irish name, he joined A.A. on March 16, 1965, after an eventful drinking career. Among its highlights were: three days on an Army train when he was 18, sozzled with Southern Comfort—"the South's revenge on Yankees," he called it; marriage (hastily annulled) in a Reno, Nev., blackout; and being asked by his own employees to stay out of a bar he owned, because he "drove customers away."

He was sure he belonged in A.A., he said, when an older member asked him about troubles related to being drunk versus troubles related to staying sober.

"When I first got to A.A., I kept looking for the secret gimmick, and I found it: The gimmick is, there is *no* gimmick, and that's tough for an alcoholic like me," he said.

Although there are no "musts," Jim said, the A.A. program does make demands on us. He told of an unexpected, sudden, almost overwhelming compulsion to drink which came two and a half years after his last drink, when he thought his life was all smoothed out. "It taught me about humility, and the need for that 11th Step," he declared.

But his first understanding of "His will for us" began to seem clear only when he desperately read the Big Book and the "12 and 12" all one night in a hospital, where his four-year-old daughter was not expected to survive. "She did, but I had by then reconciled myself to His will, not mine," he said.

"How can I not be grateful," Jim asked, "that I am permitted the responsibility of A.A. service?"

Ground rules accepted by the Conference at its initial session included: (1) all sessions closed to all except the voting Conference members (see p. 41); (2) no photographing or tape recording during Conference sessions; and (3) the "sense of the meeting" is frequently more important than formal motions.

It was also agreed that selected delegates read specified material to open each day's session, as follows: Wed., April 25—Swan J. (R.I.), the Conference warranties; Thurs., April 26—Bill S. (Ariz.), the 12 Concepts for World Service; Fri., April 27—Chris R. (Ky.), the Twelve Traditions; Sat., April 28—Lloyd G. (S.C.), the Twelve Steps.

GROUPS and MEMBERS Spring 1973

	Groups	Members
United States . . .	12,137	211,686
Canada	2,031	32,740
Lone Members . .		502
In Hospitals . . .	914	28,995
In Prisons	986	34,977
Internationalists		400
Totals	16,068	309,300
Overseas*	4,761	85,944
Totals	20,829	395,244

*1972 count; later figures not yet complete.

(Including nonreported members, actual membership is estimated at more than 650,000 worldwide, in 92 countries.)

HOSPITALITY COMMITTEE

"I'd like to come back every year," exclaimed Sandy D., nonalcoholic wife of one Canadian Panel 22 delegate. "I'm back this year because your Hospitality Committee entertained us so royally last year!"

A glance at arrangements for spouses of 1973 Conference members shows what she meant. They included: visits to an artist's studio, Calvary Church (where Oxford Group and early A.A. meetings were held), N.Y. A.A. Intergroup, and Al-Anon Headquarters; luncheons and teas at private homes; specially arranged tours of museums, the Ford Foundation, National Arts Club, and UN.

On their own, spouses went in for baseball games, opera, ballet, symphony concerts, theater, shopping, sight-seeing, and local A.A. or Al-Anon meetings.

A hospitality room on the Hotel Roosevelt mezzanine was open daily, with maps, hosts, and hostesses available.

DIGEST OF AGENDA

Tuesday, April 24

Welcome and Keynote
Why We Have a Conference
Area Delegate Chairman
Conference Committee Chairmen
G.S.O. and Grapevine Staffs
General Service Board Report
Unstructured Workshop
Sharing Session
Opening Dinner and A.A. Meeting

Wednesday, April 25

Reports of A.A.W.S. and Trustees' Committees
Request for Change of Region: Utah
International Convention Report
Trustees' and Conference Committee Meetings
Presentation: Institutions
Film Showings
Workshop: The A.A. Group

Thursday, April 26

Trustee Election
Presentation: Electoral Procedure for Regional Trustees
World Directory
Bill W. Memorial Fund
Unstructured Workshops
Building a Service Structure

Friday, April 27

Grapevine
Conference Committee Meetings
Tour of G.S.O./Grapevine
Delegates Only Session

Saturday, April 28

Committee Reports
World Service Meeting Report
Report-Back on Workshops
Conference Evaluation Questionnaires

Sunday, April 29

Brunch and A.A. Meeting

"PERSONAL SERVICE HIGHLIGHTS": Each day some Panel 23 delegates reported service experience in their areas.

"ASK-IT-BASKET": Questions submitted anonymously from the floor were answered and discussed at several sessions.

IN MEMORIAM

Red D., Ariz., Panel 22
Jim W., N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich., Panel 22
Patricia G., S. Fla., Panel 21
Jim H., trustee
John R., trustee

'Speak Out Loud and Clear'

As a delegate to the Conference on Panel 6, it was beyond my wildest dreams that 17 years later I would serve as a trustee and deliver the keynote address at a Conference. I have been richly blessed in A.A. My continuous sobriety, one day at a time, has been, I believe, the result of continuous attendance at meetings, nightly conferences with God as I understand Him, and willingness to accept responsibility as an expression of my gratitude.

I had to be willing to set up the chairs, to accept the responsibility of being group secretary and then group chairman, going on Twelfth Step calls, and participating whenever asked. I am grateful I still have the opportunity to express my gratitude by serving.

In my opinion, my greatest responsibility is to walk down the street sober. This is as good a time as any to remind everyone that as a regional trustee I am *not* a "super-delegate"; I am, like most of you, an alcoholic only one drink away from a drunk.

I am no longer afraid someone will find out I am a member of A.A. As a student in the university, I went through the stage of being very conscious of my anonymity. Now I am pleased to learn I am not violating the Traditions if I inform my colleagues, my minister, or my doctor that I am a member of A.A. I need always remember, however, my responsibility never to mention to anyone that another individual is a member. It is

my responsibility to cloak any member with as much anonymity as he or she desires.

The Traditions of A.A. have been put to the test in our changing society. Time after time, the Traditions have withstood the test and remained the rock on which the structure of A.A. is erected. Of grave concern to A.A.'s in our present society is the effect of the tremendous influx of government money in the field of alcoholism study and treatment. How does this sudden increase in public interest and funding affect A.A.? What of the A.A. who finds himself working as a professional in the field of alcoholism? At the present time, there are Guidelines for both. However, discuss these items in your workshops, and speak out loud and clear.

If ever a General Service Conference had the opportunity to examine our service structure, this Conference has! All delegates will attend unstructured workshops. There, you will have the opportunity to express your *gratitude* by taking the *responsibility* for speaking out, loud and clear, the ideas to be discussed in the Sharing Session on workshop topics. If you think G.S.O., your Board of Trustees, your Conference committees are doing a good job, please say so. If you think there is something wrong with the Conference agenda, the committees, the trustees, or G.S.O., please say so. If there is something about A.A. on the area, state, national, or international level that troubles you, *share* that trouble with us. I plead that you, as delegates, not hesitate to fully express your ideas. If we share

(cont. on p. 40)

OPENING DAY

Why We Have a General Service Conference

I have the feeling from time to time that A.A. is trying to teach me something. In one A.A. experience after another, I stop and listen to hear this message, one of the most wonderful parts of my A.A. experience.

It is important for all of us to listen to the words of the Conference Charter and to rededicate ourselves to its principles, because these can guarantee the continued functioning of our beloved Fellowship. (In my mind, nothing we do here matters unless it improves the chances of the next drunk who walks in the door.) These principles have been summed up time after time in one simple lesson A.A. teaches me—*selflessness*. If our earliest members, and our first trustees, had not been guided by *selflessness*, where would we all be today?

Up to 1950, Bill, Dr. Bob and the trustees had the entire responsibility for the conduct of A.A. World Services. Spurred on by the mortal illness of Dr. Bob, the trustees finally authorized Bill and Dr. Bob to devise a General Service Conference, so our Fellowship could assume full responsibility for its affairs. In other words, Bill and Dr. Bob had to be *selfless* enough to devise a plan which would replace themselves.

Maybe a Conference is not absolutely necessary to insure our *own* recovery. But if we are to be *selfless* instead of *selfish*, we can see that "We need it to insure the recovery of the alcoholic who still stumbles in the darkness one short block from this room," as our late nonalcoholic trustee Bern Smith said. "We need it to insure the recovery of a child being born tonight, destined to alcoholism."...

I share those feelings about A.A., through my own experience. Soon after I became sober, in my own group I became the coffee maker. I became needed and trusted. I do not mean I was important to them. But it was very important to me to learn to provide service to others. *I* was not important; the service was.

Later, when I was a G.S.R., I thought a General Service district committeeman was important. And then *I* became a committee member, but only because nobody else would take the job! Later, I moved up—I became the treasurer. Every single man who had taken the job had died, so there was no one left to take it but me!

Finally, I found myself delegate. Soon after my election, I received a letter telling me I had a special responsibility at the Conference. That made me feel pretty good, of course, till I read what it was: I was to call for a moment's silence at the opening-night dinner-period. And that's all I did—my contribution was to stand up in front a whole minute, *silent!*...

In closing, let me quote what Bill said about that first Conference, 22 years ago. He remarked, "As I watched that Conference, I became entirely sure that Alcoholics Anonymous was at last safe—even from me!"

I invite all of you to join me in this prayer for the 23rd Conference: "God grant us the serenity, the courage, and the wisdom to so behave at this Conference that A.A. is entirely safe, especially from us."

—Ralph A., trustee

Building a Service Structure

Some sleepy Conference members were jolted awake the third (Thurs.) evening of the 23rd when Western Canadians put on an absorbing, contagiously enthusiastic presentation on —of all things—“Building a Service Structure.”

Subtitled “One Region’s Experience,” the presentation was introduced by nonalcoholic trustee Dr. Travis E. Dancey. It was based on a three-day Sharing Session held in Calgary the summer of 1972, as well as on the annual “training schools for G.S.R.’s” which regional service workers and past delegates run annually in Western Canada.

‘G.S.R.—What’s That?’

For quite a few years, someone would suggest a name; it would be seconded; then someone would move motions closed. Then you were congratulated—you had just been elected G.S.R.!

The usual question was “What is a G.S.R.?” The standard answer was “I don’t know, but you go and find out.” Came the day when I was congratulated. They told me all I had to do was to go to the assembly for two days, once a year. To be completely honest, I can’t remember exactly what went on there, but group problems were discussed. The delegate would report B.C. stood below the rest of the areas, so get that money to New York! They called him “the New York delegate,” and I thought he was from New York.

In the past five years, I have seen fantastic changes. Three years ago, the committee members and I took a list of all the groups in the district, and each member was assigned five or six groups. They visited each group and asked these questions:

(1) Have you a G.S.R.? (2) Are you registered with G.S.O.? (3) Are you registered with B.C./Yukon Assembly? (4) How many active members in your group?

This took about six weeks. At the next G.S.R. meeting, 21 groups were represented out of 23. We discussed the responsibilities of a G.S.R. Suddenly, each G.S.R. realized he had a voice whether he came from a group with seven members or 70.

The assembly last November was one of the best. The group conscience was very evident. The feeling was that with unity we can get by without the extra delegate we once requested. The warmth transmitted was unbelievable. The Three Legacies were all there, each as strong as the others; the triangle was unbreakable. I believe our problem had been

lack of Unity; but, through group conscience, Unity came on strong. What good is a two-sided triangle?

In March, I called a committee meeting, to inform them of the Conference agenda items, so they would come back with the group conscience on each item. With only seven weeks’ notice, 32 committee members out of 37 attended. It was an experience I will never forget.

God, in His wisdom, let us flounder for those years, I think, knowing that one day Unity would be accomplished. The groups finally realized the importance of having a reliable and dedicated G.S.R. Group conscience, continuous communications, participating, letting the G.S.R. have his say . . . it’s beautiful!

—Al B., B.C./Yukon

What’s a District Committee Member?

An A.A. man or woman who has usually served as a G.S.R. is chosen by other G.S.R.’s as their district committee member. The committee member calls a meeting of G.S.R.’s to go through “The A.A. Service Manual,” to insure all understand. Minutes are sent to G.S.R.’s and group secretaries. Monthly meetings establish communication among groups in the district. Discussions cover group and district problems, correspondence from G.S.O., and area reports on public information, institutions, alcoholism agencies, and new groups.

The committee member’s responsibility is to visit every group in his district at least twice a year (before or after each assembly) and also at special meetings. He helps with group problems, makes sure General Service information is available, and encourages the group to support its G.S.R. The importance of the \$3.00 [now \$3.65] annual contribution per member on a monthly, quarterly, or yearly basis is pointed out.

Sharing Sessions on service are held two or three times yearly for all G.S.R.’s and any other interested members. Well-informed groups usually have a strong sense of responsibility, experience has proven.

In the area assembly, the district committee member reports activities of his district, especially programs that may help others. He keeps himself well informed on G.S.O. and his area. He uses minutes of assemblies, plus “The A.A. Service Manual.” He assists the delegate in setting up a meeting to report on the General Service Conference.

In my opinion, in selecting service workers we should look for the best available, with years of sobriety and experience, the more the better. The pleasing personality is not necessary. I suggest we look for the active, responsible, service-minded member who will serve with love. The reward will be Unity.

—Bill L., Alberta

What About the Area Chairman?

The most important thing about A.A. life is carrying the message. This is our Third Legacy of Service. We should become increasingly aware of the needs of others, particularly where those others are our friends working in the field of alcoholism. When we are very sensitive to self, we fail to understand others.

It became obvious at the beginning of my term that relationships between members of the Executive Committee should be kept congenial, so *courtesy* became a big word in the operation. This meant regular, friendly meetings, often with the district committee members and G.S.R.’s. They made it much easier to plan assembly meetings and produce detailed agenda.

We learned to make sure everyone had a fair opportunity to call discussion meetings in groups and districts far enough in advance of assembly meetings. This led to compact reports, making limited time as fruitful as possible.

Other events in the area calendar were carefully watched, so we’d have maximum attendance. Most cities or districts hold banquets, dances, and breakfasts in conjunction with our assembly.

This involvement of everyone serves to fire up people. In one place, the local A.A. group was having troubles; it had not more than five or six members, and also great differences of opinion. After our service assembly held a Delegate Day there, with past and present delegates taking part, that locality wound up with three well-attended groups.

We found that setting up our assembly room with each district at its own table eliminated a lot of unnecessary running to microphones and hamming for the audience. Each district committee member had already discussed most of the agenda at his own district meetings, so he arrived ready to report for his district.

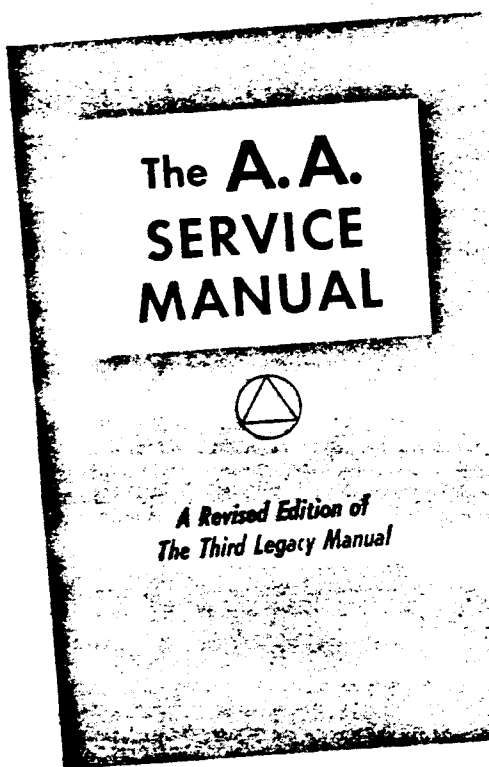
The chairman of an area has to say very little, and should say just that amount. But

the meeting can be run very efficiently, with time to spend on other things that arise for the good of A.A. The agenda, when laid out weeks or months before and adhered to, becomes interesting and not tedious, eliminating restless moving around.

The area chairman can assist the delegate by arranging report meetings and (watching out for any conflict of events) arranging a report in conjunction with some other event.

I had sessions taped, to go back and listen and think about assembly discussions.

An available chairman can be a very valuable asset in the furtherance of A.A. in the area. He must be prepared, with all the help he can get, to become and think as a leader.
—Bill H., Manitoba



Here I Am, a Delegate!

I have been granted, through my years in A.A. and rotation, the benefits of A.A. service.

In 1958, Saskatchewan adopted the Service Legacy in its entirety, and in 1964,

Manitoba did the same. I served as a G.S.R., committee member, provincial secretary, and presently as delegate. I have also been given the privilege of serving outside A.A. to help alcoholics. What better way to show gratitude than through service? My sponsor urged me to serve whenever asked. This has been a rare privilege, and the advice is cherished.

But I wonder if this would have been possible for a country lad had it not been for the avenues opened to me by "The A.A. Service Manual." During early beginnings in service, simple and forthright guidelines were a great lack. Suggestions were available at great length, but for us out in the vast regions of service, quick answers for easier education would indeed have been welcomed.

Relative to all service work is a need for directives. The thick stack of Ask-It-Basket queries is a direct reflection on the lack of early service training at the G.S.R. level. The type of A.A. education offered at our G.S.R. schools in western Canada is possible when an area structure becomes a reality and inter-group takes its rightful place of service in large group centers.

General Service opens doors for the smallest groups to a full and rightful franchise at General Service assemblies. Rotation guarantees that many will serve. Financial ability does not become a criterion of A.A. service.

During the past year, my car travels exceeded 20,000 miles on behalf of the Fellowship. Air miles, I can't remember. But it has all been worth it.

Knowledge is the key to a happy service life. We just completed a two-day training session at Regina, with over 65 committee members and G.S.R.'s present. We went through everything available—from G.S.O. to our own small-town group level. Past delegates conducted the sessions, and ten facets of A.A. were on the agenda.

Old ideas with a new approach are the outcome of our efforts: better liaison with prison officials, rehabilitation officers, and alcoholism treatment centers, and wide acceptance of Alcoholics Anonymous as the viable *one final authority on sobriety maintenance*.

Upon our first adopting the Service Legacy, some asked, "Is it possible new members from all over the province could actually run the affairs of A.A.?" Some were incensed and left; but grow we did, in number and in service. Today, hundreds of our members have a greater knowledge of service. I personally believe that the end result of real service is

unity and an awareness of the Fellowship which should be denied to no one.

A delegate may be elected. But if he comes from the hat, some G.S.R. from Armpit, Sask., draws the name—and for that moment, *he* is king. He may be our next area committee member—your next delegate.

We came from a benign anarchy to a grass-roots democracy. That, perhaps, is one of the greatest sharing sessions ever introduced into our A.A. way of life.

—George D., Saskatchewan

What One Trustee Can Do

In accepting a trusteeship, I do not know of any reason for my having been elected other than my ability to bring abject objectivity to the position through total ignorance.

We have been asked to speak on the Sharing Session held in Calgary last summer. About one hundred attended each session, and two hundred on Friday and Saturday evenings. All Canadian trustees and Western Canadian delegates participated.

The chief benefit I have noticed is a much greater awakening to the opportunities of A.A. service. I heard one member state to a more active member that he was getting bored with A.A. The active member asked what he was putting into A.A. He suggested you get out of A.A. just as much as you put into it. My friend took this advice, and he is now chairman of the area committee members. His life, as well as his A.A. work, is full of enthusiasm. As Bill always stressed, "Faith without works is dead."

At those Sharing Sessions, we have a captive audience. The ones who attend have a sincere interest in service. If we saturate one to two hundred people with the necessity and pleasure of this work, and if each of them can interest ten more, we will have pretty good coverage.

The other speakers have shown you the organization of the session. I would like to accentuate a few areas in which the regional trustee might be of assistance. If we trustees know each delegate from our region, and understand his problems, the group conscience can be better served. The area's conscience can be fed into G.S.O. on a quarterly basis, rather than annually at the Conference. Certainly, our session laid out a heavy work schedule for regional trustees. I agree with these guidelines, although in my freshman year I do not claim to have fulfilled all the following suggestions:

1. Get to know your delegates and as many area committee members and G.S.R.'s as possible. Attend assemblies, roundups, G.S.R. and intergroup meetings, and conferences. Try to carry a message of service and to encourage service people.

2. Try to bring a good grasp of your region to the Board. Try to relay the strength, weakness, feeling, and conscience of your region. Become knowledgeable. Be willing to learn. Help your region understand the necessity of assisting the Board and G.S.O. to carry on their good worldwide work.

3. Try to have a good grasp of the Conference agenda. Become acquainted with speakers, chairmen, and delegates.

4. Let's try to help by fostering unity. Training helps members understand what work is being done and why it is needed. Show them how they can grow through service work. Point out some of the payoffs—such as self-satisfaction by being of some help to an organization that has set us free! Try to make it understood that serenity can be enhanced by being of service.

Help your delegates set up a regional Sharing Session or something similar. You will be delighted at the enthusiasm toward service work engendered by education.

Matt N., Alberta, regional trustee

'Spirituality in Action'

I want to thank the Western Canada delegates and regional trustee for the presentation offered this evening. It has been presented with honesty and humility, I know. They are well aware this is not the first nor the last word on structuring an area, but only their words, sharing with us all a vital A.A. experience.

I am convinced that God's hand was never more apparent in all of Bill's writings than it is in our blessed Third Legacy. It is totally a spiritual document, and I think of service as spirituality in action.

Bill said our Third Legacy is that "least possible organization which will maintain us in effectiveness and unity." That must mean, our least possible organization is intended to bind our groups together, in loving and purposeful communication, in about the same manner as individual members are bound together in an A.A. group.

Originally, our "least possible organization" was a means of electing delegates to a Conference. Today, we see it differently. Bill

challenged us to produce a reliable 12-months-of-the-year continuing operation, capable of supporting a full measure of service responsibility. I have a job and I have a responsibility, but I can't do *your* job. Delegates should not do committee members' jobs; they should be delegates. The power and importance of A.A.'s basic principles take on new meaning for our service people in the careful consideration of watchwords like "rotation" and "anonymity" and "leadership."

Leadership is a continuing problem, just as Bill foretold. If you want better trustees, we need better delegates. If we want better delegates, we need better committee members. If we want better D.C.M.'s, we need better G.S.R.'s. Better Service suggests better Unity, and better Unity suggests better Recovery.

What is important is that we grow under God quietly and calmly and in freedom. We have no doctrine that has to be maintained. No membership that has to be enlarged. No authority that has to be supported. No prestige, power, or pride that has to be satisfied. No property or money worth quarreling about. These are advantages of which we should make the best possible use.

—Tom G., General Service trustee, Canada

* * *

A discussion followed the presentation, and Tom G. elicited the following:

- On the question "Should past delegates hold office as committee officers, G.S.R.'s, committee members?," it was the sense of the meeting they should not, but that they can perform many valuable A.A. services.
- On the question "When is a newcomer ready to learn about the A.A. service structure?," the sense of the meeting was: "as soon as it is practically possible."

Conference Advisory Action

The 23rd General Service Conference worded its agreement on both points as follows: (1) suggested that past delegates not hold office as G.S.R.'s or district committee members, but find other ways to become involved in area service; (2) recommended that newcomers should learn about, and become involved in, the A.A. service structure as soon as possible.

INSTITUTIONS

One of the most humorous, most beloved, and most applauded speakers at any A.A. Conference is always one long-term nonalcoholic trustee who is internationally respected as a criminologist and penologist (see p. 41).

"My name is Austin MacCormick," he always begins, "and I'm a secret nondrinker." This year, Austin added, "I spent a week earlier this month at the annual meeting of the National Council on Alcoholism, and now this week at the A.A. Conference—which means two weeks out of four this month I'm under the influence!"

As chairman of the Trustees' newest committee, that on Institutions, he presided at the following Conference presentation.

A.A. in Hospitals

In 1968, we had in the greater New York area 24 groups in 24 hospitals conducting 52 meetings per week. Five years later, in 1973, we have 42 groups in 42 hospitals with 125 meetings a week.

Hardly a month goes by that our N.Y. Intergroup office doesn't get a call from a new hospital inquiring about starting an A.A. group, or from a hospital where we have long had meetings, requesting additional meetings.

This may be due to the attention our disease now gets via TV and other news media, and to the awareness of the general public. But I'm sure a large amount is due to the fine job our Public Information Committee volunteers are doing, with their informative talks about our Fellowship and their power of example when meeting with doctors, administrators, and other health professionals.

Now the other side of the coin. The calls keep coming, but getting A.A. volunteers to chair the groups is difficult. Our Institutions Committee has some bylaws and guidelines. One is that each hospital group has a chairman and an alternate. Every year the chairman rotates out, and the co-chairman becomes chairman, bringing a new alternate. So every call requesting another A.A. meeting means we need two more members. Sometimes I think we are outdoing ourselves faster than we can interest our fellow A.A.'s in this Twelfth Step work. It's not a standstill, but a lack of communication between A.A. groups and the Institutions Committee.

Anyhow, A.A. is growing rapidly in New York hospitals. We're now in hospitals where they stated a few years ago, "We don't have any alcoholics here."

—John McL., Trustees' Institutions Committee
(cont. on p. 40)

'Isn't That Our Own Responsibility?'

To start active delegate participation earlier in Conference week than in previous years, members of the 23rd Conference met in nine unstructured workshops on the opening day. Seven subjects not otherwise already scheduled for Conference consideration emerged for "sharing" by the entire body, bringing forth sometimes a consensus, sometimes a variety of suggestions.

It was highly noticeable that, time after time, some delegate would remark, "But isn't that our own responsibility?" And eyes would shift to the white-on-black banner on the speakers' dais presenting the Conference theme: "Responsibility—our expression of gratitude."

1. Many new groups start and are listed at G.S.O., but many have a short life. What can be done?

At first, a few suggestions were made about requiring a group to meet some months before being "officially registered" at G.S.O., being listed in the *World Directory*, and receiving the usual packet of free literature sent each group by G.S.O. However, it was agreed that delegates and area committee members have a responsibility to help keep new groups alive. Therefore, delegates asked that G.S.O. notify the proper delegate whenever a new group is registered in his territory, and said that it is the responsibility of area committees to notify G.S.O. when a group goes out of existence. It was agreed that if G.S.O. has received no communication whatever from a group for two years, the delegate should be notified that G.S.O. is about to

drop the group from its records unless the delegate otherwise recommends.

2. What can we do to encourage better understanding of all our Traditions?

More Traditions meeting were suggested, as was better sponsorship—that is, sponsors' doing a better job of interpreting the Traditions to newcomers.

3. How can we strengthen and improve relationships between central offices and area General Service committees?

Delegates described the following plans that have worked: close liaison (exchanging members) arrangements; joint sharing of public information responsibilities; sharing space in local A.A. bulletins.

4. Is it appropriate to consider a new pamphlet or other literature on "filth in language" at A.A. meetings?

Although most delegates who spoke deplored the use of dirty jokes and profanity at A.A. meetings, it was agreed that no such pamphlet should be issued. "Isn't that our responsibility, to set the example?" more than one speaker said.

5. Should we encourage and foster more public information meetings?

The answer was a resounding "Yes." Noted Tom M., Southeast regional trustee, who moderated the sharing session: "To say no would be like voting against motherhood." It was emphasized that the purpose of such meetings is to let alcoholics know A.A. is here, and willing to help.

6. How do we convey to other members that we are losing the value of 12th Step work if we neglect our primary purpose?

As one member phrased it, "Are we letting detox and rehab centers do too much of the job we are supposed to do as sponsors?" Here, too, members' sense of personal responsibility shone through. Delegates suggested rereading the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and the chapter "Working With Others" in "Alcoholics Anonymous." No one denied that example is probably the most attractive way to teach others what experience has taught recovered alcoholics in A.A.

7. How can we improve relations with the medical profession, with the idea of having doctors refer alcoholics to A.A.?

A suggestion frequently echoed was "Go back to see your own doctors after you have learned to stay sober, so they can see your recovery." One delegate reported mailing letters and pamphlets to local physicians; another told of a plan for each student in a local medical school to have an "A.A. sponsor" who takes the young medic to A.A. meetings. Giving doctors subscriptions to the Grapevine was also urged. "Dr. Jack" Norris, G.S. Board chairman, reported on addressing a plenary session of the N.Y. State Medical Society on how A.A. will happily work with doctors. He said he wished all medical societies would hold such meetings. Copies of Dr. Jack's talk were available for delegates. The new Public Information Manual published by G.S.O. has special material on working with doctors.

Report: World Service Meeting

Although I have been sober several years, from October 4 through October 8, 1972, I was drunk on A.A. love. Serving as one of your delegates to the World Service Meeting was the most memorable time of my A.A. life. Experiences, strength, and hope were shared. We had but one primary purpose and one language — the language of the heart.

Many of the bad experiences and joy reported in "Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age" are being experienced in many countries. Nationalism has adversely affected A.A. in some. Groups in the capital of one country will not cooperate with their General Service Office, because it is in a "less important city." In another instance, groups complained because the literature distribution center is run by an A.A. member "who is not a natural citizen of our country."

The Agenda/Admissions Committee of the World Service Meeting recommended:

- That delegates should be legal residents and preferably citizens of countries they serve.
- That both delegates be A.A. members or one A.A. and one non-A.A. That A.A. members should have at least two years of continuous sobriety and five would be desirable.
- That one of the two delegates come from the General Service Board or the overall service committee.
- That the other be a salaried or volunteer staff member, capable of carrying out suggested procedures and responsibilities.
- That both delegates have a working knowledge of the English language, as the meeting will be conducted in English.
- That the two delegates have leadership

qualities, genuine service interest, organizational ability, a knowledge and love of A.A., and time to come to the World Service Meeting fully informed on A.A. in their country or zone.

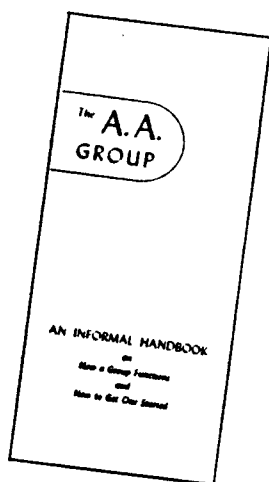
g. And, perhaps even more important, the delegates should have the time to present and carry out the agreements reached at the meeting.

Many problems came to light in the workshops on publishing and literature policies.

1. All felt that the main purpose of printing and distributing literature is to carry the A.A. message to the sick alcoholic.

2. There were almost as many ideas as there were countries about what criteria should be established for permission to print.

It was agreed at the first World Service Meeting that the meetings should be rotated from one country to another. The Site Committee recommended that England be the



Other first-day workshop topics were reported on by John D. (Ga.) Saturday afternoon, using reporters' notes from each section. Sense of the meeting often could not be determined, and no "Conference action" occurred on these matters:

(1) "Wearing two hats" for personal gain; (2) clubs—their values and outside contributions; (3) professional treatment units and the influx of new members; (4) using an A.A. wallet card as a personal calling card; (5) working with D.W.I. schools; (6) group officers with pill problems who continue to hold office; (7) better understanding of our Traditions; (8) the individual A.A. member's role in working for legislation; (9) a simpler statement on anonymity; (10) discord among groups in an area; (11) closed meetings' becoming too large; (12) coping with con men;

site of the third World Service Meeting in 1974. Delegates recommended that the W.S.M. be held every two years and that the delegates serve a four-year term.

To illustrate how strict some members are on anonymity, one delegate reported a member had been sober over 13 years and his wife did not know he attended A.A. meetings. She took full credit for his sobriety.

The fact that the Grapevine is copyrighted and the necessary action to be taken when reprinting material from the Grapevine, to protect that copyright, were reported to the delegates.

To top off this memorable experience, delegates and spouses traveled to Bedford Hills, to visit with Lois at Stepping Stones. We saw the places where Bill worked and lived. With Lois telling about many of the mementos, his presence could be felt. After a

(13) A.A. membership statistics; and (14) allocation of group contributions.

Workshop on "The A.A. Group"

Ruth H. (S.E. N.Y.) summarized workshop discussion of questions on the A.A. group (second day) as follows:

1. What is an A.A. group? An A.A. meeting?

An A.A. group is two or more alcoholics meeting on a regular basis, adhering to the Traditions, with some sort of service structure. A meeting is a gathering of people for discussions or other presentations of A.A. for the benefit of those present. Meetings aren't necessarily groups.

2. What about special purpose groups, such as women's, stag, young people's, or "gay" groups? Should any be listed in the *World Directory*?

A majority of workshop sections felt such groups violate the 3rd Tradition (membership requirement), but one did not, and some had no opinion. It was the general feeling that if any such groups are listed, all should be, but there was widespread sentiment that no special groups of any kind should be listed.

Conference Advisory Action

The 23rd General Service Conference recommended as an agenda item for 1974 a discussion of special purpose groups.

very welcome lunch, all joined hands, and Lois led us in the Serenity Prayer.

I am most grateful to my Higher Power and to this Conference for the wonderful experience of serving as one of your World Service delegates.

—Ben P., Pratt, Kansas, W.S.M., delegate from U.S.-Canadian G.S. Conference

Conference Advisory Action

The 23rd General Service Conference accepted the proposal for electing delegates to the World Service Meeting, representing the U.S. and Canada, in accordance with the procedures followed by other countries.

3. In what way, if any, have meeting formats changed? Should they? New developments?

Although formats differ from area to area, not much change is noticed. Content of meetings has changed, with fewer drunkalogs and more discussion of the Steps and Traditions.

4. Is sponsorship really slipping, or merely changing?

Five sections said changing; three, slipping; one did not answer. In a majority of workshops, it was felt there is a difference between making a 12th Step call and being a sponsor. Three workshops said there is difficulty in finding members who will do 12th Step work. Six workshops reported that newcomers are encouraged to choose their own sponsors after they have been in A.A. a little while.

Workshop on "The Inactive Member"

Although the format was open, one set of workshops was asked to consider the subject of the inactive A.A. member and how to get him or her active again. Marge R. (N. N.J.) reported this digest of workshop suggestions:

(1) Try to interest them in special local projects, such as institutions, P.I., committee work, etc.; (2) ask them to speak at special meetings; (3) find ways of keeping them active *before* they leave, since older members feel pushed aside in group activities; (4) try oldtimers' banquets and meetings; (5) encourage them to do 12th Step work; (6) tell them we need their experience and wisdom; (7) remind them they are needed at meetings as examples; (8) visit them at home; (9) sponsor oldtimers; (10) if physical impairment prevents attendance at meetings, offer a ride; (11) change format of meetings to add variety, so the oldtimer will not become bored; and (12) inactivity may reveal improper sponsorship in the beginning.

It was agreed that, in the final analysis, the basic responsibility for sobriety lies with the individual, so "Live and let live." But we should remain available to help.

Concern was also expressed for people with shorter terms of sobriety, since some Conference members feel more of them are leaving our groups than oldtimers. The latter leave by choice, perhaps; but why do newer members leave?

It was suggested that responsibilities of group officers, as noted in the pamphlet "The A.A. Group," be mentioned occasionally in Box 4-5-9.

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE

The Conference Committee on Trustees and the Trustees' Nominating Committee established the current method for electing regional trustees in 1963. The plan was approved by the Conference delegates. Since then, several changes have been made. However, other proposed changes, after careful review, have been disapproved. It was felt that they were not in A.A.'s best interests at that particular time.

**Questionnaire:
Electoral Procedures
For Regional Trustees**

1. Do you find the procedures for election of regional trustees now in use* satisfactory?
2. Do you feel the electoral procedures should be changed?
3. Please state your reason.
4. Please check the alternate procedure you feel best solves the problem.

(1) The Trustees' Nominating Committee continues to review résumés for each candidate's eligibility for nomination, but only delegates from the region involved and Conference Committee on Trustees vote in the election.

(2) The Trustees' Nominating Committee continues to review résumés for each candidate's eligibility for nomination. Delegates from the region involved, Conference Committee on Trustees, and the chairman only of the Trustees' Nominating Committee vote in the election.

(3) The Trustees' Nominating Committee continues to review résumés for each candidate's eligibility for nomination but only delegates from the region involved vote in the election.

(4) The Trustees' Nominating Committee continues to review résumés for each candidate's eligibility for nomination. Voters to consist of delegates from region involved — plus an equal number of voters — 1/2 to come from the Conference Committee on Trustees and 1/2 to come from the Trustees' Nominating Committee.

(5) Only delegates from the region involved review résumés for each candidate's eligibility and vote in the election.

(6) The Trustees' Nominating Committee continues to review résumés for each candidate's eligibility for nomination. Delegates from the region involved, Conference Committee on Trustees and six members of the Trustees' Nominating Committee vote in the election.

(7) Rotation of trustees by state or province regardless of A.A. population.

(8) That all delegates to the Conference approve or disapprove candidates, and vote on all Class B trustees, eliminating both the Trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees from the electoral procedure.

*Composition of electors in use at present:
(1) delegates from electing region; (2) members of Conference Committee on Trustees;
(3) members of Trustees' Nominating Committee

At its January meeting this year, the Trustees' Nominating Committee recommended that electoral procedures for regional trustees be discussed at the 1973 Conference.

Article 10 of the Conference Charter says:

The General Service Board: Composition, Jurisdiction, Responsibilities: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous shall be an incorporated trusteeship, composed of alcoholics and nonalcoholics who elect their own successors, these choices being subject, however, to the approval of the Conference or a committee thereof. Alcoholic regional trustees are, however, first nominated by a state or province in the region, and then the Trustees' Nominating Committee, the Conference Trustees' Committee, and the Conference delegates from the areas in the region involved make a joint selection of a nominee by a two-thirds written ballot or by lot. This nominee is then elected to the General Service Board, the trustees being obligated by tradition to do so.

The Trustees' Nominating Committee, as a result of the Delegates-Only Meeting at the 1972 Conference, discussed the election procedures at length at our July and January meetings. A subcommittee has been appointed to make a thorough review and report back to the whole Trustees' committee.

To assist the subcommittee in its review, a questionnaire has been prepared which has been distributed to you, and is shown here.

(A member of the Trustees' Nominating Committee polled his region for suggested alternate procedures, and some of those are listed. We believe we have considered all alternatives, but if you have other suggestions, we would be interested to receive them. We ask you to complete this questionnaire and return it to Betty L. or me before you return home, so the Trustees' Committee may consider your answers at our July meeting; then a recommendation will be made to the 1974 Conference.)

—Junior A., Mass., chairman

CONFERENCE COMMITTEE

Under the existing procedure, the Conference voters for election of a regional trustee are:

1. Delegates from the electing region
2. Members of the Trustees' Nominating Committee (representing the General Service Board)
3. Members of the Conference Committee on Trustees (representing the General Service Conference delegates)

If a member of the Conference Committee on Trustees is also a delegate from the elect-

ing region, an alternate replaces him or her on the Conference Committee on Trustees, and the delegate votes with his own region. This procedure was in "The Third Legacy Manual," and now stands in "The A.A. Service Manual."

Last year, the Conference Committee on Trustees considered two suggestions for changes and recommended that the present procedure not be changed. But at the Delegates-Only Meeting, the procedures were discussed by the delegates. There was a strong feeling that the procedures should be reviewed.

It was the sense of the Delegates-Only Meeting that the present allocation of votes is inequitable. There was a strong feeling that the Trustees' Nominating Committee all voted in a bloc and all knew in advance whom they would be voting for.

An illustration of the alleged inequities occurred in the election of the regional trustee from Western Canada in 1972. The Trustees' Nominating Committee held 10 votes, and the delegates from the region held 4 votes. This totals 24 votes, with two-thirds needed for election (16 votes). Under this example, if both the Trustees' committee and the Conference committee centered on the same candidate, they *could* elect a trustee who could possibly receive *no* votes from the delegates from his region. The question was asked: "Is this equitable, and would it truly reflect the feeling of the area?" However, this assumes, of course, that the Trustees' committee does in fact vote as a bloc, and that the Conference committee votes in a bloc also.

I have attempted to present this matter as objectively as possible. Now I would like the privilege of a personal observation. As chairman of the Conference Committee on Trustees, I have reviewed the history and actions of this committee from 1951. I feel it is important for you to know the previous actions of this committee.

In 1964, delegates were asked, "Are electoral procedures for regional trustees satisfactory?" All delegates were satisfied with then-current procedures, and a resolution reaffirming the procedures was adopted unanimously.

In 1965, following careful review, the Conference committee agreed that the procedures continued to be satisfactory.

In 1969, 1971, and, as previously mentioned, 1972, various suggestions were re-

for Regional Trustees

ceived by the committees, but none was recommended for approval.

As an individual, I find it difficult to believe that the Trustees' Nominating Committee does, in fact, vote as a bloc. I believe each individual decides for himself. I feel the same way about members of the Conference committee—delegates like yourselves. Last year, I personally reviewed all the candidates' résumés, and decided on the person I felt would best do the job. At no time was I approached by any trustee or any delegate about any of the candidates. I saw no evidence of any politics.

Having had the opportunity to review so many résumés, I feel we are most fortunate to have candidates with the background, experience, and sobriety that the candidates have. We will be fortunate indeed to have any of them serve as our "trusted servants."

Therefore, I urge that caution be our byword when we consider changing the present election procedures. They have taken us through the whole history of the Third Legacy, and our Fellowship has prospered under the excellent leadership. Let us deliberate, examine, and make suggestions, but let us proceed very cautiously before making any changes.

—Carl K., Delaware, chairman

Conference Advisory Action

The procedure for election of regional trustees was reviewed, and the 23rd General Service Conference recommended that the Questionnaire Regarding Electoral Procedure for Regional Trustees be filled out and sent to G.S.O. by June 1 for study by the Trustees' Nominating Committee at their July 1973 Meeting. The Trustees' Nominating Committee will make a proposal/proposals to the 1974 Conference for consideration.

World Directory: Use and Timing

PROPOSED GUIDELINES FOR CURRENT USAGE OF THE WORLD DIRECTORY — PART I (U.S. & CANADA)

The 22nd Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference, held in April 1972, recommended that a set of specific guidelines be prepared by G.S.O. covering the use of the *World Directory Part I*.

At that time, 90 delegates agreed that their names could be used for all referrals from G.S.O. in order to answer inquiries from both A.A.'s and non-A.A.'s. Since we needed additional guidance in order to prepare the above-mentioned guidelines, a followup in the form of a questionnaire was sent to all delegates in November 1972, asking specifically the following two questions:

1. Should G.S.O. have permission to use all names in the *World Directory* for 12th Step contacts?
 - a. For alcoholics seeking help?
 - b. For non-A.A.'s seeking contacts for sick alcoholics?

2. Delegates who were present at the 1972 General Service Conference unanimously agreed that their names could be used for all referrals from G.S.O. Are you still in agreement on this point?

Eighty Conference areas responded to this questionnaire, with 76 agreeing that names from the *Directory* could be given to alcoholics as 12th Step contacts. On the other hand, only 52 answered positively to the question about non-A.A.'s seeking contacts to help sick alcoholics. Since there was not a two-thirds majority, it is not possible for G.S.O. to give names from the *World*

Directory to any non-A.A. source as a part of current procedure.

In answer to question 2, 78 delegates agreed that their names could be used for any referrals from G.S.O., with 2 abstaining.

The present policy concerning the *World Directory* is that it is considered a confidential publication and is to be used for A.A. purposes only. It is not to be used as a mailing list or for any form of solicitation or commercial venture.

Directory requests from non-A.A. sources are referred by G.S.O. to the General Service Conference delegate in the area from which the request comes for approval, before issuing the *Directory*.

It has been G.S.O.'s experience that, in most cases, the delegates have given consent with the understanding that the *Directory* be used by non-A.A.'s only for referring alcoholics to A.A. in their home communities.

—Beth K., G.S.O. staff

Conference Advisory Action

The 23rd General Service Conference unanimously accepted the guidelines for use of the *World Directory* as presented to the Conference.

WORLD DIRECTORY STUDY COMMITTEE Report and Recommendation

Our *World Directories* are an important service tool, a source of A.A. contact whenever needed by groups and members everywhere.

Purpose, content and production were studied carefully. The most pressing problem is production. For the second consecutive year, the *Directory* was not available for the Conference, in spite of additional employees in the Records Department, many hours of overtime, and every other possible effort. *Part I* is now in production and will be mailed in June, we hope. We are all disappointed it was impossible to have it ready April 24!

Clearly, a change to newer methods is necessary; since at long last it may now be financially possible, we strongly recommend:

That there be a one-year moratorium on the Directory to allow time to explore in depth new systems for production of the Directory and time to change over to whatever new system is selected.

This means the next *Directory* published will be *Part II* (overseas), which will appear in the summer of 1974, the first one produced under the new system. *Part II* will be followed by the biannual issue of the two *Institutions Directories* in the fall of 1974, and by *Part I* (U.S. and Canada) in the spring of 1975.

This recommendation was presented to the Trustees' Policy Committee and the General Service Board. They approved, and recommended it be considered by this Conference.

—Midge McF., G.S.O. staff

Conference Advisory Action

The 23rd General Service Conference granted a one-year moratorium on publication of the *World Directory* as presented to the Conference.

The Grapevine—Best Reflection of A.A. Life Today

"Because it is reborn every month," said editor Jack M., "the Grapevine is the newest and best reflection of A.A. life as it is today."

Introduced by Grapevine Board chairman Ralph A., the Friday morning panel was one of the most enthusiastically received items on the Conference program.

EDITOR

The Grapevine is in a healthy condition, read today by more members of our Fellowship than ever before.

About six years ago, there was a need to find a new editor. It was suggested that Paula and I be made co-editors. We had been around 14 years and had survived the storms and personalities. Paula is the managing editor, and I am called the editor. Between us, we put out your Grapevine, sharing responsibility equally. Neither of us sees the Grapevine as a place for personal journalism; the message it carries is too precious to be trusted to the whim of any one editor.

When our Editorial Board — made up of professionals in publishing, writers and artists — meets, we evaluate the Grapevine and seek out new thinking and directions, and as the result of our sharing, assignments for special articles may be made on the spot.

Paula handles all correspondence and is first reader of all manuscripts. The Grapevine is able to select from an abundance of good material because Paula has stimulated good writers to write more and bad writers to become good.

Manuscripts for a given issue are read by an expert copy-reader who serves us part-time. [Jack introduced Janet G.] Printers' galleys are read for typographical errors.

At this stage, I begin a paste-up. The magazine is laid out to present a pleasing display of art and typography. Heads and blurbs are written, and artwork is indicated. I believe very strongly that the appearance of the Grapevine is extremely important.

Three or four professional artists in A.A. make finished drawings for us.

I do the Victor E. strip each month, which is getting to be a pain in the neck. I've about run out of things to get him away from those swinging doors.

We stress humor a great deal. We believe that laughter has a healing quality, and when

we begin to laugh at ourselves, we are on the road to recovery. We publish regularly a humor column made up of quips and anecdotes sent in by readers and put together by an A.A. who is a professional writer.

Some talented cartoonists contribute regularly, but we use their work faster than they can supply it. We are constantly on the lookout for good cartoons from our readers. So far, we have avoided reprinting cartoons from other magazines.

Some things, we do not publish. We do not use tributes to individuals, living or dead, and we do not publish poetry. It seems from our mail that every second member is a poet. We receive tons of poetry, most of it very bad. We avoid hurt feelings by not publishing any.

We think the Grapevine reader is concerned not so much with past drinking as with recovery. The Grapevine today deals with the strength and joy of living A.A. as a way of life. We talk about spiritual growth, how to cope with fear, depression, and ego — things we need to strengthen our sobriety. You won't find as many drunks in the Grapevine today; you will find more sobriety.

Yes, we want a bigger circulation and we want more subscriptions, but most of all, we want more people reading, using, and talking about the Grapevine. Go home with the idea that the Grapevine can help. Talk about it with folks back home, and get them talking about it.

—Jack M.

MANAGING EDITOR

My name is Paula, and I am an alcoholic. Hi!

[Paula then introduced Kitty K., circulation manager, and five nonalcoholic Grapevines: Mary Corrigan, Mary Warnock, Arthur Nauhauser, Fred Kehrhaan, and Susan Cruickshank.]

The Grapevine day begins with the mail, the most stimulating hour of the day. The contributions pour in, and just one good letter or manuscript can turn a rainy day into sunshine.

I have to write to many other A.A. publications to explain our copyright policy. Naturally, we want to share with all A.A. magazines, but many of them use Grapevine material without giving the source. Our copyright can be legally endangered if credit is not given. Anyone could reprint material.

Communication with our readers and writers is a high spot to me. To share the joy of new writers when they are published in the Grapevine is a real satisfaction. They never receive one cent for their efforts; in fact, when ordering extra copies they enclose checks. And those who are professional writers send words of gratitude when we use *their* contributions — and seem to have no resentments when we don't! Where, but in A.A. . . ?

Jack and I have been indexing the articles in the Grapevine. We began this work in July of 1971. We felt there had to be a better way than spending days trying to locate a piece on, say, sponsorship, supposed to be published in the 1950's—only to find, days later, that it was in a 1962 issue.

We worked backward through the sixties and fifties to that famous Volume 1, No. 1, of June 1944. As we approached the finish line of this work, a great sense of awe engulfed me. Here before us was the living, breathing, pulsing A.A. of three decades.

When the first Grapevine came off the press, it didn't make much of a splash. It was D-Day, of World War II. Yet this was the very reason for the birth of an 8-page newspaper—"to keep A.A. members in the armed forces in touch." They called it their "meeting in print," and every A.A. known to be in the services was sent the Grapevine free until World War II was over.

More and more, Bill was using the Grapevine as a means of communication with groups. Starting in August 1945, he wrote a series of pieces on A.A.'s experiences, ending in April 1946 with "Twelve Points to Assure Our Future." Discussion was hot and heavy for more than four years. Should we drop anonymity? Should we accept fortunes left in will? What should we do about clubhouses? Membership rules? Bleeding deacons? Finally, in their present form, the Twelve Traditions—as hammered out in the Grapevine—were accepted at the 1950 Cleveland Convention as our second Legacy, that of Unity.

An increasing number of nonalcoholics were reading the Grapevine, and many of them knew little about A.A. So, to clarify what we are and what we are not, the June Grapevine of 1947 carried, "Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship of men and women who share . . ." Yes, our well-loved Preamble, written by the Grapevine editor.

I feel deep gratitude for the opportunity that has been mine—to identify with the whole movement of A.A. through the pages of the Grapevine.

—Paula C.

Questions and Answers From the Floor

LITERATURE

Q. Please explain again the Conference policy on "approved" literature.

A. The 1972 Conference went on record as not approving or disapproving any literature other than our own — but did suggest that Conference-approved literature be displayed separately from other literature.

Q. The pamphlet "Who Me?" is considered unnecessary in our area. Is this so?

A. This is a local question. It is not Conference-approved literature, but many A.A.'s like it. Whether it is displayed or not is a matter of group autonomy.

Q. In the light of Tradition 6, what is the rationale behind the selling of Conference-approved A.A. literature by an outside enterprise? For example, the publications catalog of Hazelden in Minnesota carries a listing of A.A. literature available to order.

A. Basically, we are a publishing company and required by law to sell to whoever wants to buy. We have asked Hazelden to separate our literature from others, and we believe they have done that.

Q. In our area, very little of our Conference literature is understood by the Mexican-American. Is it possible to get permission to reprint Conference-approved literature in local dialects such as Chicano Spanish?

A. We have literature in good Castilian Spanish, which they should understand. Chicanos have access to meetings where they can get the message face to face. Since Chicanos are Mexican-Americans, they can write to the literature distribution center in Mexico City. The pamphlet "What Happened to Joe" is available from that office and is very easy to read.

Q. Is there any way central or intergroup offices could get a better break on the price of books and literature?

A. There is a standard discount of 15% for packages of 500 or more of a single pamphlet.

Q. What is the present status of the biography of Bill?

A. In progress. Just completed research of Bill's early days as a boy.

GROUP AFFAIRS

Q. Many groups are experiencing massive growth, and consequently many members cannot be reached to discuss their problems at a single closed meeting. Should these groups form smaller groups, so the closeness of an A.A. discussion meeting can be kept

and all attending can be given a chance to talk?

A. This is a matter of group autonomy. Many groups do split up.

Q. An alcoholic who works as a counselor starts a meeting reading the Big Book or 12 Steps for roughly 20 minutes. Then there's an open discussion with both A.A.'s and non-A.A.'s participating. Is this considered an A.A. meeting?

A. This sounds like an information meeting about A.A., rather than an A.A. meeting.

Q. Should groups that make it a practice of having speakers who talk about their pill problem, and don't mention anything about alcohol, be listed in A.A. Directories as an A.A. group? Should we accept money from such dual-purpose groups?

A. When we know it is a dual-purpose group, it is not listed, and we do not accept contributions from such groups.

Q. What are the feelings and position of G.S.O. regarding alcoholics who also have drug problems, and how does A.A. as a whole intend to deal with this problem?

A. The subject is covered in "Problems Other Than Alcohol." This point of view has been reconfirmed by several recent Conferences, e.g., 1970 and 1972.

Q. What about people on Antabuse getting out of treatment? Explanation.

A. Antabuse is a prescription drug, and A.A. takes no position on it. It is not a mind-altering drug, nor addictive — as our experience indicates sedatives, tranquilizers, and stimulants can be for alcoholics.

Q. What can we do about the member who constantly swears and drives people away from meetings, especially newcomers?

A. This is a matter for the group conscience in terms of the common welfare.

Q. Is it within the Traditions of A.A. for a group to contribute to a drying-out place run by A.A. people?

A. This is a violation of Tradition 6.

Q. What is the opinion of the Conference about the practice of some groups having permanent, nonrotating officers?

A. Opposed.

Q. What are the feelings of G.S.O. about commercial answering services? One area, which turned over confidential information to such a service and then found a responsible A.A. member to answer the phone instead, found it impossible to get the commercial service to return this information without threat of a court order.

A. We have no position on commercial answering services, though they are used in many areas, apparently successfully. Matter of group autonomy.

12TH-STEPPING

Q. Are there any guidelines for 12th Step calls?

A. The Big Book has about 15 very detailed pages on this subject in the chapter "Working With Others." Also, suggestions are in the pamphlet on sponsorship and in the Grapevine.

Q. When an A.A. member is called on to make a 12th Step call and no other A.A. member is available, should he or she take an Al-Anon or some other non-A.A. along to assist on the call?

A. This should be played by ear.

PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS

Q. How should A.A.'s deal with the problem of those attending A.A. on a probationary attendance meted out to them by judges in their area? If such a person attends meetings, but is obviously still drinking, should A.A.'s sign the attendance slip condoning his presence?

A. This subject is covered in Guidelines on Court Programs. The local judge should be made well aware that A.A. never guarantees sobriety and that signing a meeting slip simply denotes "attendance at an A.A. meeting." A.A. welcomes all referrals, and 100% sobriety from the first meeting is not expected or required.

Q. What is the opinion of G.S.O. about members of the clergy who are A.A. members holding so-called A.A. spiritual or religious retreats?

A. From "Cooperation but Not Affiliation," p. 13: "Traditionally, A.A. does not sponsor such gatherings. There is no such thing as an A.A. retreat, any more than there is an A.A. hospital or an A.A. clinic. Members participate in such activities as individuals."

Q. Our industrial relations chairman (at our local intergroup) has asked for suggestions in breaking through in this field. Has anyone approached this problem through unions? If so, how?

A. There are Guidelines and pamphlets on the subject, and this material can be adapted to individual situations as they arise. Many unions are interested in and publish material about alcoholism.

ALABAMA/NORTHWEST FLORIDA — After being sober two years, I was elected G.S.R. At my first assembly, I knew I wanted to become as involved in service as I possibly could. A.A. will let those who want to work do so. I have had the opportunity of serving our area several ways. To me, holding elected offices is just a small part of service; but, as in so many other aspects of A.A., the rewards are too numerous for me to count or even recognize.

— *Gerald H.*

ARKANSAS — The first group I attended was all women. At each meeting, one would say, "I got something from New York, but forgot to bring it." After several months, I asked a man what "something from New York" meant. He gave me a copy of the old Secretary's Handbook. This gave me welcome knowledge of the structure of A.A. In 1954, I became G.S.R. and have been serving ever since. I was chairman of the 9th All-Women's Conference in Little Rock in February.

— *Anna K.*

BRITISH COLUMBIA/YUKON — When I first contacted A.A., I was in the Navy. Other members said, "Contact A.A. wherever you go." This I did. Later, I became an Internationalist. I wrote G.S.O. and received the latest listings. One 4-month trip was very memorable because of this service. Aware of the importance of service, I later became a G.S.R. When I realized my ignorance of "The A.A. Service Manual," I made an attempt to study this publication.

— *Al B.*

CALIFORNIA (North Coastal) — Six months sober, I asked what "General Service" and "G.S.R." meant. The answers were as fuzzy as my sobriety. I was told to read "A.A. Comes of Age" and "The Third Legacy Manual" (now called "The A.A. Service Manual"). My sponsor started telling me to be at this or that meeting. One was the assembly, where the registration slip asked what group I represented. I wrote the name of the group I liked best. After the word *contribution*, I nearly died while getting a five-dollar bill out of my own pocket. I became G.S.R. without knowledge, qualification, discussion, or election. No one objected, so I did start receiving *Box 4-5-9* and got sincerely involved. Later, the secretary for that same group mistakenly filled in *her* name on the "G.S.R." line of the Group Information Card, so I was fired just like I was hired.

— *Merle G.*

CALIFORNIA (South) — A committee member informed our group we did not have a G.S.R. Thus, only six months in A.A., I was introduced to General Service. The secretary informed me this would be my job. Now, as delegate (pulled from the hat), I hope I can contribute a little. This year we have an A.A. Calendar of Service Events, showing both General Service and local service activity. Our committee and ex-delegates have special projects to increase the number of informed workers at every service level.

— *David H.*

COLORADO — I'm from the site of our 40th Anniversary Convention in 1975. My first taste of service came early in my A.A. life. I moved to Colorado Springs in 1958, and was asked to stand for G.S.R. I had attended conventions, but always as a spectator. Once involved, it was great. We got intergroup going again, seeing group conscience work with groups that didn't think they could work together. This Conference is a far cry from the jail I was inhabiting in 1956.

— *Don P.*

CONNECTICUT — About seven years ago, my sponsor and co-sponsor were talking about an assembly. I asked what the

assembly was about, and I ended up as G.S.R. This started a whole new phase in my recovery. I felt people in service had more than some others. Somehow, there is a different bond, a different understanding. The honor of serving as delegate has now been given to me—I was drawn out of the hat.

— *John C.*

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA — Some oldtimers asked me to speak about A.A. on radio and to nonalcoholic groups. To answer questions about A.A. services, it was necessary to "step outside" the local viewpoint. Serving as G.S.R., one comes to understand that his group might not have been there if it had not been for G.S.O. This vantage point gives me a greater appreciation of our continuing miracle.

— *John W.*

FLORIDA (North) — Someone mentioned a "sponsor." I was told I could adopt one I liked. I chose a fellow 11 years sober, a state committeeman. After his two years on the committee and my two years in A.A., he promoted me: got me elected to the committee after our group elected me G.S.R. He impressed upon me that giving myself to the Fellowship at any level was true anonymity, and not to expect any glory or honor.

— *Bill P.*

FLORIDA (South) — After a year of sobriety at an Air Force base in Tampa, I was transferred to England. My English friends introduced me to General Service. I went to meetings where discussions often became heated, and then they would table the issue until they could write G.S.O. in New York about keeping within the Traditions. Later, I enjoyed a year of Texas-brand A.A., then retired to Tampa. It is my great pleasure to serve as delegate.

— *Brick B.*

HAWAII — My service activity started from a resentment at not being twelfth-stepped when I needed it. I promised myself I'd see this did not happen to another suffering alcoholic. After leaving the halfway house, I became very active. In Oahu, we lack group strength, but we are attempting to follow group structure. Our outer-island groups show the true *aloha* spirit. A.A. members of Hawaii appreciate our visitors from all over the world.

— *H.J. ("Pete") P.*

ILLINOIS (Chicago) — I make 12th Step calls, sponsor new members, chair meetings, start new meetings, visit hospitals and prisons, speak at meetings, do committee work at local, metropolitan, state, and national levels, empty ashtrays, and fold chairs because I *enjoy* doing these things. In A.A., God has given me the gift of responsibility. The greatest gift was chairmanship of the "Common Services Committee" that reunited A.A. service in metropolitan Chicago.

— *Norman A.*

ILLINOIS (South) — When I came out of a state hospital, I met my outside sponsor. At his direction, I became interested in A.A. duties other than meetings and speaking. As a committeeman, I helped start new meetings and support old, sagging ones. Often, broke newcomers would be most helpful at state conferences — if they were able to attend. I noticed a university was sponsoring "seminars." In 1972, we had one of our biggest state conferences there at a weekend cost of \$23 per person.

— *Charles ("Chuck") L.*

INDIANA (North) — After I was dry about two years, my sponsor told me if I did not go to meetings and get with the program, I would end up back on the booze. I have tried to follow that advice — get off the "pity-pot" and get busy. I have run the gamut of service jobs, from group secretary to delegate. My pet project is my local union's committee on

Highlights

alcoholism, to help our members who get into trouble through alcohol.

—Jim S.

IOWA—At my first meeting, what impressed me most was friendliness. One reason the program works is service to your fellow alcoholic. At the 20th Anniversary Convention in St. Louis, I realized the field of service in A.A. is much broader than just my home group. From G.S.R., I moved on. I played a role in starting a new group in 1960. From this sprang 12 other groups. Truly, we keep sobriety by giving it away.

—“Van” V. N.

LOUISIANA—I am grateful for you who are still sharing and feeling the mighty hand of “I am responsible” upon your shoulders. My sponsor began carrying me to state assembly meetings. After my first year, I became interested because of the broader view of A.A. — a state, a nation, and a world involved in service for the suffering alcoholic. As long as we follow the paths of those before us and look to God, we have nothing to fear.

—Travis H.

MASSACHUSETTS (East)—After three years, my sponsor asked me to attend an assembly. I did not know what it was, but if he wanted me to go, I would. He said, “You have received so much from A.A., it’s time you put something back.” A.A. people with unselfish dedication won me over immediately. Being active in General Service work is one of the best ways I can express my gratitude. I look forward to serving the 428 groups in my area. I know my life will be greatly enriched.

—Dan S.

MICHIGAN (Central)—Asked to replace a G.S.R., I said yes, not knowing what this was. This was my first General Service work. I became very involved with alcoholism group therapy in Hurley Hospital. We now have two A.A. meetings in the hospital each week. For years, we had just two committeemen; now we have five. A.A. is growing by leaps and bounds in Central Michigan.

—Bill H.

MICHIGAN (Southeast)—In March 1958, I attended my first meeting. In September, I attended my first General Service meeting, embarking on a path into the heart of our wonderful Fellowship. Our G.S.R.’s meet every two months in different areas. In 1962, we held the first of our spring G.S.R. rallies. In 1972, the delegate decision went to the hat, and I was chosen. I hold dear to my heart this opportunity.

—“Gus” J.

MINNESOTA (South)—After attending Founders’ Day banquets, I was chosen G.S.R. I knew there had to be more to A.A. than staying sober, so I began to attend our area conference. I went to the Toronto and Miami Conventions, and there learned a lot. After Miami, I read “The Third Legacy Manual.” Our committeemen have been very busy getting groups to elect G.S.R.’s. At a monthly district meeting, we have good attendance of G.S.R.’s.

—Earl L.

MISSOURI (East)—I attended my first assembly in 1964 as an observer, to take notes. I have not missed an assembly since. We have a permanent P.I. committee in the St. Louis area. Our institutional committee serves all male adult prison facilities in Eastern Missouri. In 1972, we had a well-attended workshop on strengthening the area, cooperation with intergroup, and strengthening each group.

—Paul C.

MISSOURI (West)—My area service started when a man stated, “You are our G.S.R., to represent us in a meeting starting in a

few minutes.” I was group secretary and treasurer at the time, not very old in the program. Little did I know that afternoon was the beginning of a great experience! After serving as G.S.R., I was chosen alternate delegate and am now trusted servant of our area as delegate.

—Lucille T.

NEVADA—A member gave me a copy of “The Third Legacy Manual” in my early sobriety. At an assembly, Cliff W. told how the office that is now G.S.O. helped get A.A. started on the west coast. Lou H. emphasized the need for service to perpetuate A.A. “Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age,” pamphlets from G.S.O., Box 4-5-9, and *Conference Reports* have a lot to do with my service life. How much more rewarding can it get?

—Bob H.

NEW JERSEY (North)—Reading Guidelines, I decided I led a double life — civilian and A.A. As an employee of the police department, I approached our judge about a court referral program. I had to reveal my membership if the program was to be a success. After seven years, it wasn’t easy to have my co-workers find out I was a member of A.A. I no longer lead a double life. A lot of tension is gone. I feel great inside. This is the Third Legacy in action in my life.

—Marge R.

NEW YORK (Central)—In 1949 I heard Bill give a talk on his and Doctor Bob’s plan to turn A.A. over to its members. I was much impressed. Years later, I discovered it had to do with my ability to carry the message. Where did my leaflets come from? The Big Book? These questions were answered for me when I became a G.S.R. Last October, my name was drawn from a hat. I shall be eternally thankful.

—Larry J.

NEW YORK (Southeast)—After two years in A.A., I was made a “You’re it” G.S.R. for my group. I was not very good, and I did not understand all that was going on. But no one else wanted the job, so I continued. Then our committeeman wanted out, and no one else wanted the job. I said, “Yes.” Now I really began to *understand* service. Like other things in the program, if you bring the body, the mind will follow.

—Ruth H.

NORTH CAROLINA—In 1956, I joined a small group. The natives did not like to cross the county line, so for anything outside the group, I was appointed. At the next state convention, group conscience rang a bell. I wanted to learn more to serve A.A. Four years ago, our assembly came into being. It has brought unity, shortened our line of communications, and raised our contributions to G.S.O. I hope I can always serve as a trusted servant.

—Zeb M.

NOVA SCOTIA/NEWFOUNDLAND/LABRADOR—For years my wife made noises like “Mumble, Jack and Bill sober, mutter, A.A., mumble, why can’t you, mumble, money, etc.” But it was my family doctor that finally made the contact. We ask the alternate G.S.R. and the group secretary to attend monthly G.S.R. meetings with the G.S.R. Thus two additional members became service-minded. Should the G.S.R. or alternate forget to report to the group, the secretary does.

—Al M.

OHIO (Central and Southeast)—Involvement in G.S.R. work seemed to come naturally after my election to the advisory board of intergroup. Being P.I.C. chairman whetted the appetite. I am serving my second term as treasurer of the Columbus Area Council on Alcoholism and have just been appointed to Mid-Ohio Regional Alcohol Authority. I am interested in seeing that agencies give proper treatment.

—Lowell B.

(cont. on next page)

SERVICE HIGHLIGHTS

OHIO (Northeast)—The area I represent is not General Service-oriented, due to the density of A.A. members and a correspondingly great number of groups. We have so much at the group level that the majority of members do not maintain touch with other matters. When my drinking ended in 1953, our delegate was Ethel M., first woman in our area to become a member. She attended the Conferences, but did nothing more. I was not even aware an International Convention was held in St. Louis in 1955. The responsibility of being delegate is great, but I am confident God will see me through.
—John B.

OKLAHOMA—As chairman, I decided we should invite A.A.'s from other towns and was told to get me a *World Directory*. Through the *Directory*, I became interested in General Service. No one else was interested, so I became a self-appointed G.S.R. I tried to vote, and they wouldn't let me, since mine was an institutional group. However, I do love the Fellowship, and most of the people in it.
—Wilson P.

ONTARIO (East)—My group informed me, "You are now our new G.S.R. Good luck." I tried to see the group had literature, institutional commitments were kept, and contributions paid to G.S.O. and to Ontario. As institutional chairman for about 45 institutional groups, I saw to meeting commitments and distribution of literature. I worked closely with the administration of each institution to iron out differences. As committeeman, I went around helping new groups and seeing they were registered.
—Charles P.

ONTARIO (Northeast)—I became interested in General Service through my sponsor. I was a member of a small group, which met at 8:30 p.m. It was a joy for me to arrive at 7:00, prepare the coffee and chairs for the meeting. My fellow members encouraged me to be G.S.R. At first, I had a tough time with myself. Gradually, it became easier, and I enjoyed the work.
—Robert F.

ONTARIO (Northwest)—My service work began when, shortly after gaining sobriety, I saw that members with contented sobriety were active in service. I soon got a job in a halfway house and had to wear two hats. I was directed toward public information, and my intense involvement in service began. It has most certainly strengthened my sobriety.
—Murray S.

PENNSYLVANIA (East)—When I was chosen G.S.R., we had five members. I had no idea what a G.S.R. was. I had no fear, however; I'd ask an older member. Then I had fear, for not one member knew! A gal told me she saw one once—he wore a suit, white shirt, and tie, and talked about ambitions, or traditions, something like that. Then came a district meeting. Wearing my suit, white shirt, and tie, I walked in. We saw the G.S.O. film-strip. Then the delegate spoke. This man just exuded enthusiasm. I had been depressed, wondering, "Is that all there is?"—meaning coffee, cake, and meetings. I realized I lacked something—service. When I was elected G.S.R., I thought I was being used. Since then, I have learned a valuable A.A. lesson: If you love me, use me.
—Joe deB.

PENNSYLVANIA (West)—I was shanghaied into my first service job, and I thank God for it. I took the job of committeeman about four and a half years ago and attended every meeting and assembly in Western Pennsylvania. I also visited each and every group I was responsible for. In October, I had the great privilege of being elected delegate for my area. In my service, all I ask my Higher Power and A.A. is to do the best possible job I can in all matters.
—Francis F.

QUEBEC (Northeast)—I sent a friend of mine to Al-Anon, and she became delegate for Quebec. She often spoke about the Al-Anon Conference. I wasn't doing anything in A.A. except criticize those who did something. She told me that from her first 24 hours, she had started to read all she could about Al-Anon. She added, "Without serving, I would not be happy today." I was sober but not happy, so I started to do the same. I did it to be happy, just like my Al-Anon friend.
—Marcel J.

TEXAS (Northeast)—A lady in my group interested me in attending an area General Service meeting. Since our group did not have a G.S.R., I was asked to serve and was elected area treasurer. But the great reward has been all the friends I have made. The lady later became my wife. Together, we have visited many smaller groups in our area—a blessing for the love and warm feeling we have received.
—Pat M.

TEXAS (Southeast)—My first G.S.O. meeting was surely a different type than I had been used to. I was elected G.S.R. because no one else wanted the job. After two years, it dawned on me: When you accept an office, you better know something about it. I had to start all over reading the "12 & 12" and the "Manual," thinking about their meanings for myself and A.A. as a whole. I believe service work has meant the difference in continued sobriety, peace of mind, and happiness for me.
—Don A.

UTAH—I had been in A.A. 16 months when my sponsor, the G.S.R., agreed to serve two more years if he could have a working alternate—me! The following May, I was elected chairman of our Skyline Conference; next, chairman of our state service committee. I learned to take criticism as a nonpersonal fact of service. I could only do my best, remembering I was a trusted servant.
—Jack C.

VIRGINIA—From the beginning, I became active. I've served as intergroup representative, G.S.R., and treasurer for our state committee. Now the climax. I shall do my best to keep the confidence of the people responsible for my election. One of my aims is to generate more interest in our state committee and G.S.O. For this privilege, I'm very grateful.
—Fred C.

WASHINGTON—After being "took sober," I had the "I wanna tell about it from the rooftops" syndrome. But there was a vacuum of *what* to tell. Sponsors told me of "A.A. Comes of Age," "Twelve and Twelve," and the G.S.O. Public Information Kit. Speakers' bureaus, radio-TV shows, and localized articles—all were chances to tell the A.A. story. A county committee on alcoholism reinforced my need for the knowledge in "Cooperation but Not Affiliation." Business trips have showed me A.A. from New York to Tokyo. I'm grateful to have been selected as delegate.
—Ted K.

WEST VIRGINIA—I was sober two months when my sponsor took me to an assembly. This was six years ago, and 13 people were present. Now, at the two-day assemblies we hold twice a year, the attendance is over 100, with 60 to 75 groups represented. I feel fortunate to have gotten in early in my sobriety. It has been a rewarding experience.
—George E.

WISCONSIN (South)—By serving others in A.A., I have also been able to serve myself. For all the people that took the time to help me, I give my service in return. Service is involvement. Nothing is so constructive as knowing you are involved in helping another person, the community, a group, or A.A. By being of service to one another, we are living examples of the A.A. way of life.
—Virginia H.

A.A. Growth Sets a Fast Pace for G.S.O. and GV

A.A.W.S.

REPORT: A.A. World Services, Inc., is a membership corporation, in effect a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. As members of the corporation, the trustees elect the directors of A.A.W.S., Inc. at their annual meeting in April.

In 1972, Steve O. was elected chairman, and the six other directors include a president, 1st vice-president, 2nd vice-president, treasurer and two other directors, and they elect their officers usually in May. Two new job categories have recently been established at G.S.O.—an assistant general manager and an administrative assistant to the general manager. Meetings of the Committee on Office Policy and Procedure are held weekly to review problems and opportunities pertaining to office policy only—not to policies affecting A.A.

The A.A.W.S. Board meets regularly once a month to act on matters within the jurisdiction of A.A.W.S., Inc.: to establish prices on new books and pamphlets, review requests to reprint Conference-approved literature, and attend to matters pertaining to publishing and administration of the General Service Office. Those attending these meetings, aside from the directors, are G.S.O. staff members, the assistant general manager, the administrative assistant, a representative of the Grapevine, the controller, and the office manager. Reports are given at these meetings on Finance, Grapevine, Public Information, Professional Relations, etc.

Publishing

There was a substantial growth in distribution of A.A. literature in 1972. Sales totaled \$834,800, an increase of \$156,300 over 1971. A.A.W.S., Inc., besides carrying its own costs, donated \$100,000 to the General Fund to help defray costs of other services which voluntary contributions failed to meet.

Distribution of all books, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items in 1972 amounted to 4,750,000 individual units. Furthermore, the number of free pieces of literature to service new groups and familiarize the public with A.A. amounted to 294,200. This free material carried an inventory value of \$9,960.

Accounting

It is the responsibility of the nine full-time employees and one part-timer of this department to process all literature orders and record all contributions received at G.S.O. It also maintains the general books and prepares payrolls, financial reports, budget-controls, and comparisons. The number of orders processed totaled 19,800 in 1972, and the number of contributions came to 23,200.

Records

It is the responsibility of the nine girls, in Records to compile information for our *World Directory (Part I and Part II)*, as well as for the two Institutions directories. They also maintain files for all new groups, Loners, Internationalists, delegates,

LITERATURE DISTRIBUTED — 1972

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	84,908
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Reg. Edition)	32,587
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Gift Edition)	10,762
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	9,707
As Bill Sees It	15,183
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish Edition	1,783
Total	154,930

PAMPHLETS

This Is A.A.	235,637
A.A. — 44 Questions and Answers	211,773
Is A.A. for You?	442,919
Young People and A.A.	118,119
A.A. for the Woman	106,770
Bill on Alcoholism (formerly Alcoholism the Illness)	126,437
The Alcoholic Husband	116,157
The Alcoholic Wife	87,871
Memo to an Inmate	33,176
Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic	135,163
The Jack Alexander Article — About A.A.	70,712
The Fortune Story About A.A. (discontinued)	54,692
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	73,353
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	71,313
What Happened to Joe	101,164
It Happened to Alice	69,860
The A.A. Group	54,201
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	39,235
Inside A.A.	41,802
The G.S.R.	57,065
Suggestions for Beginners Meetings	3,547
Student's Guide to A.A. (discontinued)	99,307
A Brief Guide to A.A. (new)	65,135

A.A. and the Medical Profession	65,829
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	58,236
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	43,914
A.A. in Prisons	16,045
A.A. in Hospitals	33,087
Alcoholism Is a Management Problem	60,837
The Fellowship of A.A.	85,583
A.A. in Your Community	127,331
The A.A. Service Manual	7,773
Why A.A. Is Anonymous	79,825
Problems Other Than Alcohol	76,581
A Member's-Eye View of Alcoholics Anonymous	78,542
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	12,500
Co-Founders of A.A. (new)	31,099
Profile of an A.A. Meeting (new)	28,846
A.A.'s Legacy of Service (new)	18,646
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	29,357
If You Are a Professional (new)	28,741
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated (new)	73,582
Understanding Anonymity (new)	25,844
Total	3,397,606

MISCELLANEOUS

Tapes of A.A. Talks	401
Wallet Cards — 2-fold	810,409
Wallet Cards — "I Am Responsible"	124,670
Parchment Scrolls	2,611
Plaques	2,049
How It Works	117,133
Beginners' Meeting Kit	3,547
Group Handbook	890
Wire Racks	575
Cassettes	255

G.S.O. REPORTS

G.S. committee members, etc., as well as updating the G.S.O. mailing list.

Shipping

The 13 full-time and five part-time employees process both incoming and outgoing mail and fill all literature orders.

During the year 1972, shipping processed:

Incoming letters	81,187	
Outgoing letters	87,240	
Outgoing parcels	60,384	
	18,724	<i>Directory, Part I</i>
	6,896	<i>Directory, Part II</i>
Total parcels	86,004	

This year, the Scriptomatic system was installed for mailing purposes.

Steno/Clerical

This department consists of 18 employees. Eleven serve as transcribers or as recording secretaries on the various Trustees' committees. Two clerk typists handle form letters and special literature requests, assisted by a receptionist and a switchboard operator. Three take care of filing and research.

—Steve O., chairman
A.A. World Services, Inc.

STAFF COORDINATOR

STAFF REPORT: At present, nine staff members work at your General Service Office, each with a specific service assignment. These are: Staff Coordinator, Service Coordinator, U.S.-Canadian Conference, Professional Relations, Public Information, Overseas, the World Service Meeting, the 1975 Convention, Institutions, Internationalists, and Lone members. These assignments also carry responsibility for the preparation of bulletins and reports, as follows:

Box 4-5-9 (in English and French)	Service Coordinator
Quarterly Report	Conference
About A.A. (Professional Relations Newsletter)	Professional Relations
Box 4-5-9 (in Spanish)	Spanish Correspondence
P.I. Bulletin	Public Information
World Service Meeting Report	Overseas
Institutions Bulletin	Institutions
Round Robin	Internationalists
Loners Meeting	Loners

In addition, each has the secretarial responsibilities that go with committee work:

Staff Coordinator	Assistant Secretary to Board of Trustees, Secretary to the Trustees' Policy Committee and Committee on Conference Policy
Service Coordinator	Secretary to the Directors of A.A. World Services, Secretary of Trustees' and Conference Literature Committees

Conference Secretary	Secretary to Conference Agenda/Admission Committee
Professional Relations	Secretary to Trustees' and Conference Professional Relations Committees
Public Information	Secretary to Trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees
Overseas	Secretary to World Service Meeting Committee
Institutions	Secretary to Trustees' and Conference Institutions Committees
Lone Members	Secretary to Conference Committee on Trustees

As it was in the beginning, when the first great rush of letters began to come into the office as a result of the Jack Alexander *Saturday Evening Post* article, the major work of the staff lies in answering correspondence. Approximately 1,000 letters a month are answered individually by the staff. Each staff member handles the mail from specifically assigned areas. A very rewarding aspect of staff work is the many A.A. conferences, assembly meetings, and state or provincial get-togethers we are invited to. We have an opportunity of making many new A.A. friends and renewing old friendships; but more important, we are able to get information which helps us to be a better service office.

Visitors from every part of our A.A. world come to see us, and each staff member has the pleasure of greeting these visitors. The Staff Coordinator attends meetings of department managers and the Office Policy and Procedures Committee. She also tries to keep the staff informed about any activities which may concern them. Daily folders of correspondence are circulated to all, and so is a folder of publications.

Staff meetings provide a forum for discussion of A.A. problems reported in the correspondence.

June R., our newest member, joined the staff on March 5. It is good to have her as a part of our G.S.O. family.

—Ann M.

SERVICE COORDINATOR

STAFF REPORT: Since G.S.O. is primarily a service office, and carrying the A.A. message is its main objective, here are some of the services provided to help A.A. groups and members meet their responsibilities of service:

New Groups — A complimentary supply of literature and a Group Handbook is sent to each new A.A. group. Each is added to the G.S.O. mailing list and receives Box 4-5-9 every other month. In 1972, 2,278 new U.S. and Canadian groups were added to our list. Also, 706 groups, no longer active, were taken off the list.

World Directories, Parts I and II — *Part I* (United States and Canada) is issued in the spring of each year, and copies are mailed to the full A.A. mailing list in the U.S. and Canada. *Part II* (Overseas Groups) is available in the fall, and these directories are mailed to all overseas groups then. (The Conference action reported on page 13 will change *Directory* timing in the near future, of course.)

The directories are confidential and should be used only for providing contacts for A.A. members. They are not to be used for any form of solicitation or commercial venture. Directory requests from non-A.A. sources are referred to the General Service Conference delegate in the area from which the request comes.

Hospital and Correctional Facility Directories — These are prepared every two years, since there is little change in group information in these categories.

Guidelines — The preparation of Guidelines is the responsibility of the Service Coordinator. We now have thirteen, on these subjects:

1. Alcoholic Rehabilitation Centers
2. Armed Services
3. Central or Intergroup Offices
4. Clubs
5. Conferences and Conventions
6. Court Programs
7. Institutional Committees
8. Public Information
9. Relationship Between A.A. and Al-Anon
10. Industry Programs
11. A.A. Participation and Cooperation During Alcoholism Information Month
12. A.A. Cooperation with Alcoholism Agencies and Facilities
13. For Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field

Films — Three 16mm color films are now being distributed. "Bill's Own Story" is loaned free to A.A. groups in institutions, and rented to regular A.A. groups at \$35.00 per week. "Bill Discusses the Traditions" is rented at \$35.00 per week. "Time for Decision" rents at \$20.00 a week.

The new G.S.O. filmstrip, our fourth, describes G.S.O. services and staff. Titled "Welcome to G.S.O.," it sells for \$6.00.

Tapes and Cassettes — Eight tapes are available at \$3.00 each. One cassette, a talk by Bill on A.A.'s legacy of service, is \$3.50. We keep a listing of A.A. members who like to exchange tapes, available upon request.

Box 4-5-9 — G.S.O.'s bimonthly bulletin in English, French, and Spanish is sent to a mailing list of 29,296. Individual subscriptions are \$1.00, and bulk subscriptions (10 for \$2.50) are also available. *Box 4-5-9* includes information about new and revised A.A. literature, as well as other service material. It shares information on all G.S.O. service activities, carrying worldwide A.A. news.

Service Meetings — Each month, the Service Coordinator conducts a meeting of staff members to share experience in each service and to offer suggestions for improvement or change.

Form Letters — As a result of the growth of A.A., it has become necessary to use form letters. These are kept up to date by the staff.

Literature Kits — Some literature kits are sent free of charge, and some are listed on the regular G.S.O. order form. The Service Coordinator is also secretary of the Trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, which involves updating and preparation of all Conference-approved literature.

— Beth K.

INTERNATIONALISTS

STAFF REPORT: Close to 400 Internationalists now carry the message of A.A. recovery around the world. These seagoing A.A. members keep in touch with the A.A. program by corresponding with each other and with the G.S.O. staff member currently at the Internationalist desk. They get copies of the *World Directory Parts I and II*, which serve them as meeting lists. We also issue a list of Internationalists' names and addresses, so these seagoing A.A.'s can share with one another by mail.

Six times a year, a newsletter, the *Round Robin*, is sent to all members. It consists mostly of parts of letters from Internationalists, and also of news items. On the alternate months, copies of *Box 4-5-9* go out.

This is the 25th anniversary of the Internationalist service. It began in 1948 when a seagoing A.A. member left the Big Book in three Far Eastern ports. Gradually, other seafarers were made aware of the A.A. way of life. Many A.A. groups in foreign lands today were started by Internationalists.

—Phyllis M.

LONERS

STAFF REPORT: About 550 Loners are currently listed at G.S.O., including 41 Spanish and 31 French Loners. They are A.A.'s unable to attend meetings because there is no available A.A. group. When we learn of a new Loner, we provide him with complimentary literature and some thoughts and ideas from other Loners on maintaining sobriety. We also send the *World Directory Parts I and II* and a list of other Loners, so he can begin correspondence with some of them immediately.

Every other month, these members receive *Loners Meeting*, primarily a sharing of correspondence from Loners and Loner Sponsors. On the alternate months, they receive *Box 4-5-9*. From time to time, we run an item in *Box 4-5-9* asking members who do have the advantage of group meetings to share their experience with Loners through correspondence. In this way, the Lone member receives some benefits of group experience through his or her Loner Sponsor. Almost 300 Loner Sponsors are registered with G.S.O.

We always encourage the Lone member to seek another alcoholic who wants help, and in so doing, to form an A.A. group. In the past year, we have seen the birth of groups in Ngarawahuru, New Zealand, Roberta, Georgia, and Adana, Turkey.

Lone members seem to develop an extraordinary sense of the spiritual side of our program, and sharing with them is a truly enriching experience.

—Betty L.

(cont. on next page)

INSTITUTIONS

STAFF REPORT: The "reason why" for the institutions assignment is to carry the message to the alcoholic who is confined. We offer service to almost 1,000 groups in prisons and over 900 groups in hospitals throughout the world. The number of such groups has grown considerably in the past two years, with by far the greatest growth reflected in the hospitals, as follows:

	1970		1972	
	Groups	Members	Groups	Members
Prisons	925	32,481	976	34,977
Hospitals	767	18,604	914	28,955

That's a gain of more than 50% in members in hospitals in two years. We feel this has come about from the proliferation of agencies and treatment centers set up to combat alcoholism. Regardless of the initial treatment offered the alcoholic, A.A. is usually recommended as the continuing "treatment" necessary for recovery. Hence the tremendous increase in these A.A. groups.

To help extend the hand of A.A. in this setting, the following services have been developed:

1. Correspondence—from this office, and through the Institutions Correspondence Service
2. New Groups—registering hospital and prison groups, and sending complimentary literature to these new groups
3. Institutions Directories—sending updated directories for groups in prisons and hospitals every two years
4. *World Directory*—sending it annually to confined groups
5. *Bulletins*—Each institutions group receives copies of *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly and *Institutions Bulletin* three times a year.
6. Literature—Discount packages of A.A. literature are available to A.A. groups on the "inside."
7. Guidelines—for A.A. groups in institutions, on: Alcoholic Rehabilitation Centers; Court Programs; Institutional Committees
8. Tapes and films—available free of charge on a loan basis to institutions groups
9. Institutions Committees—to help at the local level to carry the message to the alcoholic who is confined
10. Conference Committee on Institutions
11. Trustees' Committee on Institutions

The Institutions Correspondence Service now has about 300 people involved, almost double the number last year.

We have heard from several areas concern that the A.A. Traditions are not being fully upheld in the institutional setting, especially the Seventh. It reads: "Every A.A. group ought to be fully self-supporting, declining outside contributions." But there are instances where this is not possible.

It is recommended that local groups and institutions committees support institutional groups in their area. G.S.O. offers special discount packages of literature to confined groups, because their funds are hard to come by. Down through the years, it has been felt that our primary purpose must be fulfilled at all costs. If we are to survive, we must carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic wherever he may be.

—Phyllis M.

PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS

STAFF REPORT: During the past year, the Trustees' Committee on Professional Relations has had many opportunities to carry the A.A. message, not only to agencies and individuals interested in helping the alcoholic, but also to the armed forces, industry, and many organizations wanting to help the alcoholic.

Committee members and staff have participated in the following events: Office of Economic Opportunity Community Action Programs Conference; 7th Annual Conference of the Canadian Foundation of Alcohol and Drug Dependencies; O.E.O. Training Center, Rutgers Center on Alcohol Studies; Advisory Committee meeting and annual meeting. Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America (A.D.P.A.); National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) annual meeting, and meetings of its Advisory Council; Eastern Pennsylvania School of Alcohol Studies; Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies; International Congress on Alcohol and the Addictions; and meetings of the Advisory Council to the Junior Chamber of Commerce (Jaycees) on Alcohol Problems (Operation Threshold).

During the past year, the Professional Exhibit has been shown at national meetings of the following: American Personnel and Guidance Association, American Educational Research Association, National Council on Alcoholism, American Industrial Health Conference, American Nurses Association, National Conference on Social Welfare, National Medical Association, Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America, American Academy of Family Physicians, American Public Health Association, and the American Medical Association (Clinical Convention). We received 1,953 requests for literature as a result.

The first issue of our new newsletter, *About A.A.*, was mailed in July, and since then the Professional Relations mailing list has doubled.

These projects were completed during the past year:

Guidelines for Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field (those who "wear two hats")
Guidelines for Carrying the Message to "Hard-to-Reach" Alcoholics
Statement on A.A. membership and problems other than alcohol
Memo on A.A. Cooperation in Research and Non-A.A. Survey Projects
The pamphlet "If You Are a Professional"

We received many inquiries and visits from people connected with programs for alcoholics, such as Maj. John M. Squires, head of the Air Force Social Action Programs in Wiesbaden, Germany, who coordinates their activities with local A.A. groups; and Navy Capt. J. W. Shute, who explained the Navy's project of distributing the Big Book to 40 merchant ships.

At the annual meeting of the A.D.P.A. in Atlanta, we put

on three workshops on these topics: A.A. members who work in the alcoholism field; how A.A. cooperates with others; how to make use of A.A. services in the community.

—Mary Ellen U.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

STAFF REPORT: Public information is a way we carry the A.A. message directly to the alcoholic who still suffers within the public sector. It also carries the message to those in a position to help the alcoholic — wife, husband, doctor, clergyman, employer, and others.

During 1972, we provided information about A.A. in response to 8,057 inquiries. Another way of carrying the message is through the press, and last year we had 3,290 press clippings.

During 1972, 155 anonymity breaks were noted.

We distributed 195 radio and TV spots.

We sent 25 one-way displays, with P.I. labels and pamphlets, to local, county, and state meetings.

Information was provided for 17 writers.

Material was furnished to the following for radio and TV shows: Celestine Ware for CBS-TV program *Woman!*; Merle Rubine for CBS radio show *Today's Woman*; Anne Baggan for the show *Straight Talk* on New York's Channel 9; Dr. Joyce Weill of Children's TV Workshop *Sesame Street*, for a health show for children; Barbara Walters for NBC-TV program *Not for Women Only*; and Dick Cavett for two 90-minute ABC-TV shows on alcoholism and the recovered alcoholic.

A.A. is now listed in 34 encyclopedias and reference books.

We updated our lists of P.I. committees and contacts, and of media (press, radio, TV).

There are 150 A.A. public information committees and 415 P.I. contacts. Since 1971, the number of P.I. contacts has nearly doubled, and we have 26 new P.I. committees. We furnish them: (1) the new P.I. Manual (background editorial material, radio-TV material, and the A.A. Fact File); (2) the bimonthly *P.I. Bulletin*; (3) radio-TV spots; (4) Guidelines for P.I. committees.

The following are useful P.I. pamphlets: "A.A. in Your Community," "Brief Guide to A.A.," "Profile of an A.A. Meeting," "Understanding Anonymity," "The Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous," "Basic Fact File," and "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings."

Major magazine articles in which A.A. was prominently featured included: "The Alcoholic Executive" in *Town and Country* (Feb.); "Do Self-Help Groups Really Help?" in *Woman's Day* (Mar.); "Bottles in Bedrooms" in *Girl Talk* (May); "Confessions of an Alcoholic" in *Dun's* (June); "Days of Wine and Heartbreak" in *Coronet* (Aug.); "Business Dries Up Its Alcoholics" in *Business Week* (Nov. 11); and three pieces in *U.S. Jaycees' Future* (Dec.).

—Valerie S.

OVERSEAS STAFF REPORT:

Membership Overseas:	86,623
Groups Overseas:	4,761

According to the 1972 *World Directory Part II*, the increase in membership over 1971 is 5,274. The increase in groups is 840, a gain of 17.6%.

There are 20 literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada. The following centers provide new groups with complimentary literature: Belgium (Flemish), Brazil, Colombia, El Salvador, Finland, France, Germany, Ireland, Mexico, New Zealand, Norway, South Africa, Sweden, Switzerland (French), Switzerland (German), and United Kingdom.

Argentina—A.A.'s in Buenos Aires are forming a literature center and have permission to print the following pamphlets: "Is A.A. for You?," "This Is A.A.," "44 Questions and Answers," and "The Twelve Steps."

Australia—These A.A.'s now have their own General Service Office in Sydney, from which the General Service Conference and publishing company will operate, servicing Australia, New Zealand, and parts of Southeast Asia.

Brazil—A literature center in São Paulo has operated since 1969, and A.A.'s in Brazil are now working towards a G.S. Board and Office.

Colombia—The G.S. Board in Colombia has printed 22 Conference-approved pamphlets, the Big Book, and "As Bill Sees It." They now have ready for publication in Spanish: "Young People and A.A.," "A Clergyman Asks About A.A.," "The Alcoholic Wife," and "A.A. in Hospitals."

Finland—The office in Finland has added to its long list of Conference-approved literature the Newcomers Kit. The Finnish Board invited Niles P. to their 1973 Conference.

Germany—Years ago, U.S. armed forces groups started holding roundups in Germany. A few Germans began to attend, and eventually a German-speaking meeting was added. Over 100 English-speaking A.A.'s will attend the 1973 German-speaking roundup in Munich, so an English-speaking meeting has been set up for them.

Mexico—the G.S. Board in Mexico now prints 18 Conference-approved pamphlets, and they hope Mexico will be able to publish its own literature approved by the Mexican Conference (assembly), covering subjects of special importance to their particular nation. A vast percentage of the present population are native Indians, and the Board would like to offer "This Is A.A." in Mayan, Zapotecan, and Nahuatl.

Norway—Nine pamphlets are available in Norwegian, as well as the Big Book and "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions." Literature flows from the Secretariat Office to all groups, and new groups receive an initial free pamphlet kit.

South Africa—In 1971, a paperback edition of the Conference-approved "Twelve Steps" joined the list of literature distributed by the Board in Johannesburg.

(cont. on next page)

Sweden—The Big Book in Swedish is now being printed, and the Central Committee expects a rush of inquiries. We sent them our procedure for handling a Loner service.

Turkey—Four U.S. armed forces groups have been formed, in Izmir, Karamursek, Adana, and Ankara. Ken H. has taped two radio interviews regarding A.A., which are used often by the armed forces radio network.

United Kingdom—A.A. literature has been published in the U.K. since 1952. Books and pamphlets are sold direct by the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous (Great Britain and Ireland) in England, Wales, Ireland, Scotland, Australia, New Zealand, and South Africa.

—Waneta N.

CONFERENCE

STAFF REPORT: First, we thank all delegates for advising G.S.O. of the newly elected delegates, officers, and committee members before the December 1 deadline for the *World Directory Part I*. Many of you also collected the group cards from your area and got them to us on time. We count on all of you to continue providing this information so the *World Directory*, our files, and our mailing stencils can be up to date.

We also appreciate area committee secretaries providing us with minutes so faithfully.

Approximately 600 past delegates are on the G.S.O. mailing list. They receive *Box 4-5-9* and the *Quarterly Report*.

Throughout the year, as we receive Conference agenda suggestions and present them to the Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee and to the Trustees' Policy Committee for approval, we share this information in the *Quarterly Report* and *Box 4-5-9*. However, the Preliminary Agenda must be approved at the January meeting of the Committee, and so is not available for distribution until early February. If assembly meetings are held in January, this makes it difficult to provide you with information. If the first assembly meeting of the year was later, it would be easier to have approved agenda topics available for discussion.

We mailed delegates "Building a Service Structure . . . One Area's Experience." A committee member in Virginia saw a report on this and edited the copy for us. We hope this is a helpful addition to the Conference Kit.

Some of the responsibilities of the Conference Secretary are:

1. Preparing the *Quarterly Report* after each meeting of the General Service Board and its committees
2. Preparing the Conference agenda, in consultation with the general manager and the Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee
3. Working with the G.S.O. Records Department to keep area committee listings correct
4. Corresponding with delegates, committee members, and past delegates
5. Attending to advance correspondence with the delegates in preparation for the Conference, and sending monthly letters after the Conference to share G.S.O. news

6. Reviewing carefully minutes and all other communications from area committees

7. Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee

8. Working with the editor on the Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* and the final *Conference Report*

—Cora Louise B.

A.A. GRAPEVINE

EDITORS' REPORT: At the 22nd Conference, the Grapevine reported circulation at 64,000, a rise of 5,000 over the preceding year. We are gratified to report to the 23rd Conference that circulation is now over 71,000, up 7,000 over last year. This has enabled us to continue without raising the price of the magazine, despite inflation.

In many areas, Grapevine representatives have been doing great work, building new interest in the magazine and in its use as a tool of A.A.

The print run of our 1973 calendar was increased from 15,000 to 20,000 and sold out completely. The full-color painting reproduction continues in demand. This print will henceforth be identified as "The Man on the Bed," to avoid confusion with the new A.A.W.S. booklet "Came to Believe."

The project to index every article published in the Grapevine since its beginning in June 1944 has been completed.

This study of the Grapevine down through the years made us more sharply aware of the tremendous body of work written by Bill W. for the magazine. Some of it has been reprinted, but much—from early Grapevines through the forties and fifties—would be new and exciting today. This material will be incorporated in a hard-cover book of good quality, to be published in commemoration of A.A.'s fortieth anniversary.

Editorially, the Grapevine continues to focus on the A.A. way of life and the search for physical and spiritual recovery, with less emphasis on drinking and the drunken episode. Rather, Grapevine material is selected to help us cope with life problems—fear, depression, self-pity, ego, and learning to love. Multi-article sections were on spiritual awareness and the Twelve Steps.

Of equal concern are matters relating to our Fellowship. This year, we completed publication of Bill's Twelve Concepts in the hope that they would create a broader understanding of service. In August, we published an outstanding article on A.A. growth, pointing out some of the problems and suggesting solutions. We carried a section on the Big Book, and continue to stress articles on anonymity.

Our November issue was made up entirely of classic Grapevine pieces from the past. The issue delighted many oldtimers and was all new to anyone who has joined us within the last eight years. Articles by Bill, Doctor Bob, and Dr. Harry Tiebout, and other pieces that have stood the test of time, all made it an outstanding issue. We plan a classic Grapevine issue for each November.

—Jack M., Paula C.

Committee Work Serves A.A.—and A.A.'s to Come

REPORT OF CHAIRMAN

I am happy to report once again the continuing healthy state of the Fellowship as seen from the vantage point of the Board of Trustees.

All available data — reports from regional and General Service trustees at our quarterly meetings, revenues from sales of books and services, contributions, Grapevine subscriptions, correspondence — indicate our Fellowship is in a period of substantial growth. Each month shows a considerable increase over the last. A.A. is, in your Board's opinion, in excellent shape.

The one cause for concern is that group contributions are still below the cost of group services. You will hear more about this from Arthur Miles, our treasurer.

The Board functions like any similar group in business or government; it has committees to consider various matters. This makes it possible to do a better job in each specific area and enables us to bring in additional help from members expert in specific professional or business areas. This saves time and effort. These committees are usually chaired by a trustee. You will hear from most of them.

I would like to touch briefly on a few items, as well as let you know about my own activities on behalf of A.A. during the past year.

The decision not to accept the Stepping Stones property was reached by the 1972 Conference. However, at Lois's request that further thought be given to the ultimate disposition of this property, a committee of A.A. and Al-Anon trustees, and our lawyer, was appointed. After serious deliberation, the committee recommended that final arrangements for disposing of Stepping Stones be deferred until after Lois's death. Lois is content with this decision.

The Board approved employment of an assistant general manager at G.S.O. It also accepted recommendations of the World Service Meeting.

The Board continued consideration of what might be done with the money contributed by members to the Memorial Fund for Bill. It has been our feeling that there is no hurry; when the right thing comes along, the group conscience will make itself felt.

Other actions included a decision to raise the ceiling on the reserve fund from \$300,000 to \$500,000, which seems prudent in times of rising costs and high operating expenses.

Now I would like to tell you about my own activities during the past year.

The New York State Medical Society held its annual meeting in February, and I was invited to give a talk on "A.A. and How to Work With It." This is the first time significant attention has been paid to alcoholism at these annual meetings.

As you may have sensed from my report of last year's trip overseas, I was less than happy at what I found. This year's trip was different. I was invited, as chairman of the General Service Board, by the U.S. Air Force Europe to participate in work-

shops for physicians, Social Actions officers, and counseling people in Germany, England, Spain, and Greece. In all areas, there is great respect for A.A. and dependence on A.A. for maintenance of sobriety. Men and women are recovering who, a year ago, were thrown out or hidden. In one instance, an officer who was in serious trouble has recovered in A.A. and has been promoted, rather than discharged. The command group really means it when it says alcoholism effectively treated will not interfere with future growth in the services. This will help more to admit their need for help and come to A.A. There is much need for interpretation of A.A. — the program, the Traditions and how to work together. Cooperation without affiliation is hard to achieve, but it is essential. In a highly structured organization where title and status are the name of the game, anonymity and the "trusted servant" concept of leadership are strange ideas.

There is a tendency on the part of commanders to use their authority to promote attendance at A.A. meetings. They seemed to accept the suggestion that official meetings, where A.A. is interpreted and encouraged, led by a knowledgeable person — A.A. member or not — could accomplish their purpose and avoid the complication of asking a group to report attendance.

In September, Cardinal Wright, Prefect of the Sacred Congregation of the Clergy, whom I met in Rome last year, met for two days with a group of recovered priests and me, at Guest House in Rochester, Minn. I think he came away with a much better understanding of A.A. and a different attitude towards alcoholism than he had before the meeting.

—John L. Norris, M.D.
Chairman, General Service Board of A.A.



LITERATURE

With the help and cooperation of the Conference Literature Committee, the Trustees' Literature Committee has completed or is working on the following projects. (Because of the 2nd

G.S.B. REPORTS

World Service Meeting, only two meetings of the committee were held during the past year.) The committee:

1. Recommended that the "Illustrated Traditions" pamphlet include representation of minority groups.
2. Recommended that the pamphlet "Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic" be updated to include consideration of other drugs as they affect the alcoholic. A possible new title is "The Alcoholic and Drug Abuse."
3. Recommended that question five of the pamphlet "Is A.A. for You?" be referred to the Conference Literature Committee for possible deletion of some words.
4. Recommended exploration of a more substantial format for excerpts from a reprint of Bill's Grapevine article "Problems Other Than Alcohol."
5. Reaffirmed the Conference committee's recommendations for a cartoon-style leaflet on service.
6. Noted that "Came to Believe" should be ready for the 1973 Conference.
7. Noted that writing continues on the booklet "Staying Sober."
8. Noted that the pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services" is completed except for additional stories: by a young A.A. who obtained sobriety in an Army setting, by a marine, and possibly by a woman in the service.
9. Declined with thanks an offer to print the booklet "A Reasonably Happy Man," which was offered to A.A. World Services, Inc., by an A.A. member.

—George G., chairman

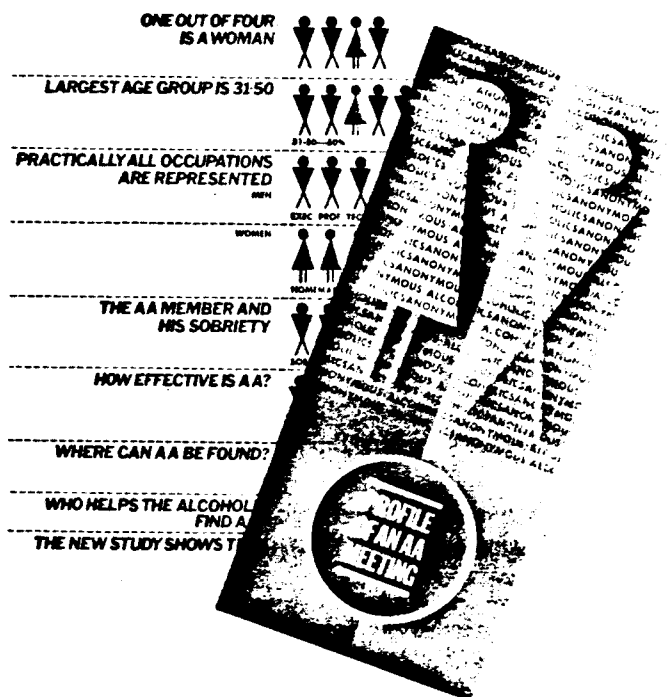
PUBLIC INFORMATION

During the past year we completed these projects: (1) "A Brief Guide to A.A." (replacing "Student's Guide to A.A."); (2) "Understanding Anonymity," a leaflet approved by the Conference Committee on P.I.; (3) the new one-way display and leaflet "Profile of an A.A. Meeting," based on information from the 1971 survey; (4) special P.I. literature discount packages, valued at \$6.58 and sold for \$5.00; (5) four color-TV public-service spot announcements (one 60-second spot and one 30-second are now in distribution); (6) our TV spots were approved by NBC's Public Service Committee for showing on network TV, reaching millions of viewers in one showing (this will not reduce the value of showing the spots locally); (7) our new TV spots were accepted by the Office of Information for the Armed Services in Washington, D.C.; (8) our *Public Information Bulletin* is now sent to A.A. Boards overseas; (9) updating two 1950 documents, "Responsibilities of the Movement for Keeping the Public Informed" and "Public Information Policy of the General Service Board."

Twenty radio spots now in preparation will feature members telling what their lives were like and what their lives are like now.

At the White House, on April 16, "Dr. Jack" Norris presented to President Nixon the millionth copy of the Big Book. We are exploring suggestions regarding a possible film about A.A. For the future, we are examining possibilities for a newspaper story on the 1971 survey, and a major magazine article on individual A.A. recovery.

—Walter M., chairman



INSTITUTIONS

The first meeting of the Trustees' Institutions Committee was held January 28, 1973. On recommendations of its members, a letter about this newly formed committee was sent by Chairman Austin MacCormick, in his professional capacity in the correctional field, to 400 correctional officials.

A copy of Austin's letter was also sent to all A.A. institutions committees and contacts. To facilitate further acceptance of A.A. "behind the walls," we plan a survey to collect information showing that A.A. in institutions really works.

We are examining all institutions literature to see that it reaches all levels of understanding.

There has been criticism that groups in institutions do not always abide by our Seventh Tradition (self-support). Members of the committee felt such criticisms are not in the spirit of our primary purpose of carrying the message to anyone, anywhere, but future editions of institutions pamphlets will cover the Tradition.

—Austin MacCormick, chairman

LONG-RANGE PLANNING

No decisions were reached at the last (May '72) meeting, but the discussion ranged over many topics for two days, in the home of the G.S. Board chairman.

It is hoped that Dr. Morris Chafetz, executive director of the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, Washington, D.C., will meet with this committee in June this year.

-John L. Norris, M.D., chairman

NOMINATING

The Trustees' Nominating Committee regularly reviews backgrounds of, and makes recommendations on, all trustee candidates for the G.S. Board, and directors of A.A. World Services and the Grapevine. Its members help elect General Service trustees.

Since the 1972 Conference, the committee recommended to the G.S. Board:

1. Election of Charles H. as a director of the Grapevine Corporate Board

2. That the following officers and directors of the Grapevine be elected:

Officers

Ralph A., president, chairman
Paula C., vice-president, secretary
George G., treasurer

Directors

Ralph A.	George G.
Paula C.	Charles H.
Thomas C.	Austin MacCormick
Charles E.	Joseph H.
Jack M.	

3. That the following trustee candidates be elected in April, following presentation to the Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

John D. Bealer, M.D.	Austin MacCormick
Travis Dancey, M.D.	Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
Vincent Dole, M.D.	Arthur Miles
John L. Norris, M.D.	

Class B

Ralph A.	George C.
Junior A.	Jack M.
Donald A.	Tom M.
George G.	Matt N.
Thomas G.	Stephen O.
James G.	Walter M.*

Robert R.

One General Service trustee, U.S., to serve four years

*A.A.W.S., Inc., has proposed Walter M. to replace Niles P. as a Class B trustee, subject to Conference disapproval, if any. Niles resigned his trusteeship on February 3, when he was appointed assistant general manager of G.S.O.

4. That the following officers be elected at the annual meeting of the G.S. Board in April, 1973.

John L. Norris, M.D., chairman
Austin MacCormick, 1st vice-chairman
Robert R., 2nd vice-chairman
George G., secretary
Arthur Miles, treasurer
Ann M., assistant secretary
Dennis Manders, assistant treasurer

5. That the following be elected directors of A.A. World Services at the annual meeting of the A.A.W.S., in April:

Jerry D.	Ann M.
Robert H.	Walter M.
Robert M.	Stephen O.
Christian A.	

6. That a General Service trustee, U.S., to replace James H. (who died before his term of office expired), be elected by the 1973 Conference for a four-year term.

The committee considered the question of an area's or region's proposing a candidate for General Service trustee U.S. (or Canada) who resides in another area. It was decided each area is autonomous in choosing a trustee candidate.

7. That the electoral procedure for Class B regional trustees be placed on the 1973 Conference agenda for discussion.

8. That a subcommittee further investigate electoral procedure for Class B regional trustees, and report its findings to the committee. The Trustees' committee will review these findings with the Conference committee; and they will then present their recommendations to the 1974 General Service Conference.

9. Recommended to the Board that the following procedure be used when an area requests a change of region, subject to the approval of the Conference Committee on Trustees and the 1973 General Service Conference:

The delegate from the area requesting the change of region will write on behalf of its assembly to the secretary of the Trustees' Nominating Committee, with copies to the trustees in the two regions involved. Then the delegate will ask G.S.O. to send a letter to all of the delegates in the two regions involved, requesting that they express their approval/disapproval on an enclosed card.

Approval by two-thirds of the delegates from each region involved is required before the proposal is presented to the Conference for final approval.

10. The Trustees' Nominating Committee reviewed the résumés of 41 candidates for General Service trustee U.S., and found all candidates eligible for election.

-Junior A., chairman

(cont. on next page)

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Overall, the General Service Office financial picture for 1972 was quite good. Net sales totaled \$830,400, an increase of \$158,200, or 24%, over the year 1971. Contributions from groups and A.A. members totaled \$564,300. This was \$65,500 more than received in 1971, a 13% increase. Total income, i.e., publishing gross profit, contributions, and interest income, increased 19% over the year 1971 — \$170,100.

As could be expected, total expenses were also up. They increased by \$130,500, or 15%, over 1971. With the exception of the nonrecurring expense of the World Service Meeting (\$14,700), the increases are directly related to the rapid growth of the Fellowship and, of course, to the higher cost of doing business.

To sum up the results of the year's operations, the net expense of the General Fund of the General Service Office, which was \$117,400, was offset by A.A. World Services, Inc., publishing net income, which totaled \$190,900. This resulted in a net income for 1972 in the amount of \$73,500, as compared to \$33,900 for 1971.

Sales of our literature and contributions reached an all-time high in 1972. All other indices point to the same conclusion: A.A. is growing at an accelerating rate. As your treasurer, I should be very happy.

But I am concerned, because contributions for the year 1972 did not quite match the increase in the growth of the Fellowship itself. The increase in membership last year was about 16%. The increase in contributions, however, was only 13% for the same period. The percentage of groups contributing decreased from 64.1% to 59.6%.

The percentage of groups contributing is still less than two-thirds. Of course, we neither expect nor want contributions from any group which cannot afford it; but we would like to see more groups involved in carrying responsibility for the many A.A. services needed all over the world. We are far more interested in having *something* contributed than in *how much* is given.

So I'm really worried only about the future. I, too, believe in the 24-hour plan, but today is the only 24 hours we have to be concerned about, and to plan for, broader-based support.

—Arthur Miles (nonalcoholic), treasurer

PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS

Many of us hate to think where A.A. would be today had it not been for such nonalcoholics as Dr. William D. Silkworth, who treated Bill at Towns Hospital, the Rev. Sam Shoemaker of the Calvary Mission and the Oxford Group, Sister Mary Ignatia at St. Thomas Hospital in Akron, and others like them.

Likewise, we hate to think where 238,000 alcoholics now in A.A. would be today if modern professional men and women had not encouraged them to come to us. Our 1971 survey showed that a doctor, a minister, a counselor, a hospital, or the boss was chiefly responsible for getting more than one-third of our present membership into A.A. In other words, one out of

every three A.A.'s did *not* voluntarily call A.A. or walk into a meeting or A.A. central office on his (or her) own. He was guided to us by some professional person.

Your Professional Relations Committee is supposed to *keep* professional men and women sending alcoholics to A.A. We'd also like to see even *more* of today's professional people turn into Tiebouts and Dowlings of A.A.'s future.

Meeting this responsibility has involved the following:

1. Nearly 800 letters asking for information about A.A. were answered.
2. 157 local A.A. members helped man our new Professional Exhibit at national conferences of 11 professional organizations.
3. Here is what happened to our new printed material:
 - (a) "If You Are a Professional" — 28,741 copies were distributed.
 - (b) *About A.A.*, our new newsletter for professionals and paraprofessionals — sent to 2,550 people.
 - (c) A.A. Guidelines for Cooperation With Alcoholism Agencies and Facilities — sent to 9,630 A.A. members and professionals.
 - (d) A.A. Guidelines for Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field (Those Who "Wear Two Hats") — sent to 3,200 A.A. members.
4. More than 150 telephone calls from professional men and women were answered.
5. Early in April, a workshop on A.A. was presented for the National Council on Alcoholism in Washington, D.C. We have been invited to make a presentation on A.A. at this year's meetings of the Halfway House Association and the Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America, as well as the North American Congress on Alcoholism in 1974.

In the forthcoming year, we hope to see more clearly how we can increase understanding within A.A. of what A.A.'s non-alcoholic friends of *today* are doing to help alcoholics.

—Steve O., chairman

POLICY

The Trustees' Policy Committee is a forum for discussion of all matters referred to the General Service Board. This provides a wide expression of opinion, and the Board is very responsive to the committees.

Bill conceived this committee as a "town meeting," in which everyone was welcome to make a comment. Such free-wheeling open discussion is valuable in getting the feeling of the group conscience. Forty or forty-five people—General Service Board trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine corporate directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff, and members of all Trustees' committees—attend, and meetings last about four hours.

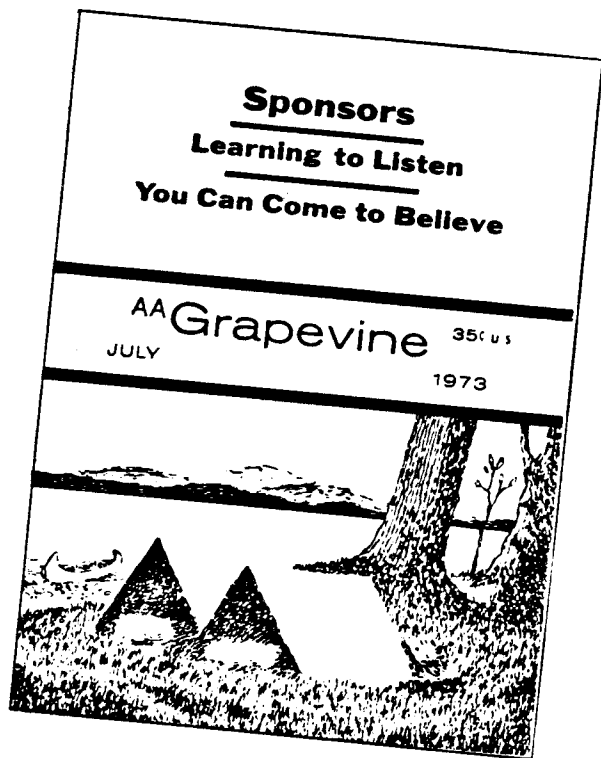
Voting members are: eight regional trustees, two General Service trustees from outside New York, two G.S.O. staff members, a trustee and a director from the Grapevine, the president and a director of A.A. World Services, and two additional trustees designated by the G.S. Board chairman. Trustees' committee chairmen deliver reports, which are discussed fully, so many eyes and ears are in on committee work. The regional trustees also report at this time.

The Policy Committee reviews agenda items for the Conference and approves the Conference theme. The chairman draws names of the delegates for the ten Conference committees.

Some subjects discussed since the 1972 Conference were: (1) *World Directory* problems; (2) *in memoriam* contributions; (3) carrying the message in Russia; (4) listing homosexual groups in the *World Directory*; (5) use of Conference-approved literature by organizations other than A.A.

Few matters are brought to a vote, since the idea is to get a sense of the meeting in order to help guide the thinking of the Board. Minority opinions, too, are noted and brought to the attention of the Board.

—Tom G., chairman



A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

A membership firm, wholly owned by the General Service Board, the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., through its Corporate Board of nine directors, is responsible for all business of the corporation, selection of the editorial staff, budgeting, etc. It is responsible for seeing that the magazine adheres to the Twelve Traditions.

Actual publication and day-to-day operation are in the hands of the managing editor and the editor, traditionally A.A. members with equal responsibility. They are assisted by a freelance copy-editor-proofreader, a secretary, and, on the business side, a staff of six for circulation, distribution, and book-keeping.

Also in the Grapevine structure is the Editorial Board, chaired by the editor, composed of the managing editor and

twelve members with editorial experience and useful professional talents. It evaluates and advises on content and makeup; creates ideas; and fulfills specific assignments.

Attending quarterly meetings of the Corporate Board are the nine directors, the circulation manager, and a representative of the A.A. World Services Board.

During 1972, we saw an increase in circulation of 11% over 1971 and a 9% increase in income from the magazine and other sales, such as the calendar and "Best of Bill" reprints.

In January, the Grapevine Directors were pleased to vote a contribution of \$12,000 to the General Fund to help support other G.S.O. services.

On September 30, 1972, the stock corporation of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., was dissolved, and henceforth the Grapevine will operate as a not-for-profit or membership corporation of the General Service Board.

In the past year, it was voted by the Directors that the Grapevine proceed with an automated data-processing system proposed by Datatron, a firm that has handled the Grapevine mailing for more than 13 years.

—Ralph A., chairman

1975 A.A. INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Denver, Colorado, will be host city to A.A.'s 40th Anniversary International Convention July 4, 5, and 6, 1975.

All Convention activities, except midnight alkathons and opening dances, will take place in the Curriegan Convention Complex. The Convention Hall seats 14,000, with ample space for workshops, daytime alkathons, and large panel meetings.

Care and feeding of our "conventioners" should be most satisfactory — especially feeding, since hot meals and sandwiches will be served cafeteria-style, at reasonable prices, right in Curriegan Hall. Snack bars, too.

Contracts have been signed with 52 hotels for 4,850 rooms. We hope to have 250 rooms at Temple Buell College. Most are twin-bedded, with one bathroom to each two rooms. They'll be available at very special rates.

Jack M., a former delegate, will be chairman of the Host Committee. Among his key aides are John N., Panel 21, and Don P., the present delegate.

Colorado's share of the Guarantee Fund, \$6,500, was raised within three months. In fact, it was oversubscribed. (The Board provides one-half, and the balance is raised by the A.A.'s in the host state.)

The Brown Palace Hotel will be headquarters for A.A., while the Denver Hilton Hotel will be Al-Anon headquarters.

Members of the Conference Convention Committee will be selected later, to work with the Trustees' committee to make this truly a "Mile-High Convention." —Bob H., chairman

The following are digests of Conference committee reports presented to the Conference by committee chairmen. Acceptance by the Conference made up the "Conference Advisory Actions." However, when the Conference rejected a part of a committee report and took other action, the action is noted separately following the report.

AGENDA/ADMISSIONS

The committee recommended that:

1. We follow the guidelines set up at last year's Conference: that the A.A. meeting on the first night be retained, and that in even years, we have delegate participation, and in odd years, we have G.S.O. and GV staff participation for short talks, with a delegate chairman. This format is to be reviewed every year by the Agenda/Admissions Committee.

2. When an elected delegate is unable to attend the Conference meeting for any reason, a past delegate can be seated in his place, for one year only, if no one else is available, with the proviso that "The A.A. Service Manual" (page 59) be reworded as follows:

"A delegate serves one term for two years. The Conference is on record in its attitude toward delegate rotation. However, the question has arisen: Can a delegate be re-elected at some future date? The Conference strongly recommends limiting the term of delegate to one two-year term, with the exception of an alternate delegate who, after filling one year of the delegate's term, may be elected to serve his own term."

And in the last paragraph, page 59, the following change be made:

"The Conference recommends that all areas have alternate delegates."

When an area is unable to replace the elected delegate, except with a past delegate, the secretary of the Agenda/Admissions Committee shall be provided with information concerning the extent of the efforts made to replace the delegate with someone who has not previously served in that capacity. She will inform the members of the Agenda/Admissions Committee, who will promptly advise her of their disapproval, if any.

3. In order to improve the functioning of the Agenda/Admissions Committee, it was suggested that:
 - a. Members of that committee, when writing to G.S.O., indicate on their letters when they wish copies to be sent to the other members of the committee.
 - b. Background material be sent to members of the Agenda/Admissions Committee on suggestions received for Conference agenda items.
 - c. Results of Conference Evaluation Questionnaire be sent to members of the Agenda/Admissions Committee.
4. All delegates try to get suggestions for the 1974 agenda to the Conference secretary by November 15, 1973.

The Conference Voices

5. The 1974 Conference discuss the possibility of a newsletter to be distributed to past delegates.

The committee elected David H. (S. Calif.) chairman, and Ruth H. (S.E. N.Y.) alternate chairman.

CONFERENCE ACTION: The Conference approved the above parts of the report of the Agenda/Admissions Committee.

However, the Conference declined to approve the following parts of the committee's report:

The committee reviewed the application for a fourth delegate from the province of Quebec, including additional data submitted prior to the Conference, and at the committee session by Elmer S., delegate from Southwestern Quebec.

The Agenda/Admissions Committee recommends that:

1. The application for a fourth delegate from the province of Quebec be denied at this time. With complete understanding of the temporary disappointment and challenge this decision represents for the province of Quebec, the committee, at the same time, is convinced that:
 - a. A fourth delegate would not provide, for the province any benefits which could not be met more adequately by enlarging and developing the district committee structure, as suggested by "The A.A. Service Manual" and guidelines suggested by the Agenda/Admissions Committee statement on the Size of the Conference and Procedure for Application for Additional Delegate.
 - b. The responsibility of the alternate delegate be more fully developed.
 - c. The action of the three Quebec provincial committees in recommending that the present three areas be represented by bilingual delegates will distribute the responsibilities more equitably.

In declining to approve the committee recommendation, the Conference voted that Quebec be allowed a fourth delegate.

The Conference also declined to approve the following parts of the committee's report:

2. The committee wishes to recommend with great earnestness and sincerity that the Conference consider the following:
 - a. That the Agenda/Admissions Committee participate, as a committee, in the final approval of suggested agenda items and their distribution to the various committees, etc., and no longer be restricted to just "making recommendations."
 - b. That the Trustees study the feasibility of the Agenda/Admissions Committee holding a full committee meeting for the proper and adequate evaluation and deliberation of suggested Conference items, including selection of the Conference theme and the evaluation of the preceding Conference agenda, prior to the Conference.
 - c. The committee also wishes to have the newly elected Agenda/Admissions Committee chairman become co-

the Group Conscience of A.A.

chairman immediately upon being elected and full chairman when the present chairman's term as delegate expires on December 31.

COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

The committee recommended that:

1. The slate of officers and members of the General Service Board be accepted for the period beginning April 1973, through April 1974.
2. The résumé of Walter M.—submitted by A.A.W.S. Corporate Board for Class B General Service trustee, effective April 1973—be approved.
3. Approval of the recommendation from the Trustees' Nominating Committee that the following procedure be used when a Conference area requests a change of region:

The delegate from the area requesting a change of region will write, on behalf of the assembly, to the secretary of the Trustees' Nominating Committee, requesting the change of region, and will send copies of the letter to the trustees in the two regions involved.

The delegate will ask the General Service Office to send a letter to all of the area delegates in the two regions involved, requesting them to express their approval/disapproval on an enclosed card. Approval by two-thirds of the delegates from each region involved is required before the proposal is presented to the General Service Conference for their approval.

4. Any résumés received after the established January 15 deadline be returned, by the General Service Office, to the delegate in submitting area.

The committee recommends that the January 15 deadline be so noted on the résumé sheet, and it is suggested that the résumés be sent to G.S.O. by *Registered Mail—Return Receipt Requested*.

5. Résumés for trustee candidates, received at the General Service Office, be presented for approval to the Trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees exactly as received.
6. In the event circumstances prevent an area's candidate for Class B trustee from serving as a trustee, the area have the right to submit another candidate after the January 15 deadline, subject to the approval of the Trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees.

The committee elected George E. (W.Va.) chairman and John W. (D.C.) alternate chairman.

Average length of sobriety of delegates to the 23rd Conference was 11.8 years.

LITERATURE

The committee recommended that:

1. The words "sometimes heavily" be deleted from Question 5 in the pamphlet "Is A.A. for You?"
2. Preparation of an illustrated or cartoon-style "Young People in A.A." pamphlet be explored.
3. A better way to communicate with doctors be explored by the Trustees' Professional Relations Committee.
4. The Unity declaration be added to all A.A. literature when feasible and economical, and the recommendation be referred to A.A. World Services, Inc., for follow-through.
5. A.A.W.S., Inc., study the possibility of having a reproduction made of the original Big Book.
6. It be noted, as a matter of information, that the code appearing on all A.A. literature stands for number of pamphlets ordered, date ordered, and printer used.

The committee elected Wilson P. (Okla.) chairman, and Gerald H. (Ala./N.W. Fla.) alternate chairman.

FINANCE

The committee took action and made recommendations as follows:

1. Authorization granted to A.A.W.S., Inc., by the 1971 Conference Finance Committee to raise the prices on books and literature, if necessary, be reconfirmed.
2. The \$3.00-per-year-per-member yardstick be changed to \$3.65 and be emphasized as a penny a day for sobriety.
3. To increase group participation (i.e., contributions) — the following:
 - a. Mailings should be aimed at the G.S.R.'s, giving them more information and asking for their cooperation. (Copies of correspondence to G.S.R.'s to be sent to all delegates.)
 - b. Delegates ask groups to contribute, no matter how little.
 - c. G.S.O. poll all delegates, asking them to contribute ideas about methods of informing groups regarding contributing regularly in their respective areas.
 - d. The G.S.R. Corner in Box 4-5-9 be reinstated, to further communications with the G.S.R.'s.
4. The General Service Board Reserve Fund ceiling be raised from \$300,000 to \$500,000.

The salary structure of the General Service Office was reviewed by the committee.

The committee elected Al M. (N.S./Nfld./Lab.) chairman and Larry J. (Cent. N.Y.), alternate chairman.

(cont. on next page)

ADVISORY ACTIONS

PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS

The committee recommended that:

1. The question of attempting to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous to the U.S.S.R. should be referred to the Third A.A. World Service Meeting.
2. In view of the impact of strong agencies and facilities on our Fellowship, evidenced by increased membership, increased need for Twelfth Step workers, and forecast of continuing increase, we should be mindful at every level of the increasing importance of the understanding and applications of our Twelve Traditions.
3. The General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous, as well as the members of the Fellowship, cooperate with agencies dealing with alcoholism, welcoming referrals, being guided by applicable Traditions, and keeping in mind as our primary purpose the welfare of the alcoholic and his recovery.
4. The Conference reaffirm that the furnishing of information about, and explanation of, Alcoholics Anonymous to professional societies is not in violation of the Traditions.
5. We encourage use of all present means of communication (Grapevine, Box 4-5-9, appropriate literature) to communicate to A.A. members an understanding of professional relations, with emphasis on availability and value of Guidelines.
6. Consideration be given to the compilation of Guidelines for Professional Relations Committees.
7. Consideration be given to a presentation to the 24th General Service Conference, "How One Area Developed an Effective Professional Relations Program."
8. The Conference reaffirm the need at all levels to recognize interested A.A. members and develop an understanding of professional relations within the framework of our Traditions, keeping in mind our primary purpose.
9. No special literature addressed to law-enforcement officials is needed at this time, because current A.A. material is suitable for this purpose.

The committee elected Murray S. (Ont. N.W.) chairman, and Travis H. (La.) alternate chairman.

COMMITTEE ON CONFERENCE POLICY

The committee recommended that:

1. Conference committees elect an alternate chairman in case the chairman is unable to attend the next year's Conference. Since the chairman is elected by a plurality, the person with the second largest number of votes could be alternate chairman.
2. An alternate area delegate chairman should be elected; the runner-up to the area delegate chairman could be alternate chairman.

3. Since the action of the 1969 Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee that "when an elected delegate cannot attend the annual meeting of the General Service Conference, the alternate delegate seated at the Conference will be considered delegate until notification is sent to G.S.O. by the area committee (as defined by 'The A.A. Service Manual') that the originally elected delegate is ready to resume his duties" is already incorporated in "The A.A. Service Manual," there is no further need for reaffirmation.
4. Past delegates should not be elected to serve again, with the exception of the suggestions outlined by the Agenda/Admissions Committee, 1973. (See page 9.)
5. Conference Questionnaire and Evaluation be continued each year; more space should be given for the answer to question 5, "How do you feel the Conference could be improved?," and a line added for general comments on accommodations.
6. Special mailings going to Conference committee chairmen should also go to alternate chairmen.

The committee elected Al B. (B.C./Yukon) chairman, and H. ("Pete") P. (Hawaii), alternate chairman.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

The committee recommended that:

1. Two documents recently updated by the Trustees' Public Information Committee, "Responsibilities of the Movement for Keeping the Public Informed" and "Public Information Policy of the General Service Board," be approved, with the provision that the following sentence be underscored: "*We must recognize that our competence to speak about alcoholism is limited in subject matter to Alcoholics Anonymous and its recovery program.*"
2. There is a real need for public information speakers to place greater emphasis on our recovered way of life, rather than our drinking experiences.
3. The need for greater understanding by A.A. members of public information be recognized, and one way to accomplish this might be to have area committee members help to acquaint the membership at large with public information literature and its use, stressing that P.I. work is a good way of doing 12th Step work.
4. The P.I. Kit be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee on P.I. for the purpose of keeping it effective and up-to-date.
5. All delegates cooperate with P.I. committee chairmen (in areas where there is a P.I. committee) in an effort to share P.I. experiences, both good and bad, with G.S.O. so that others might benefit via the *P.I. Bulletin*.
6. Reaffirmation of the recommendation made by the 1972 Conference Committee on Public Information: that it is the responsibility of the delegate to set up a public information committee in areas where there is none.

The committee elected Virginia H. (S. Wis.) chairman and Francis F. (W. Pa.) alternate chairman.

INSTITUTIONS

The committee recommended that:

1. A letter be sent to local institutions committees or contacts asking them to send G.S.O. a list of hospitals and prisons where there are currently *no* A.A. groups.
2. G.S.O. conduct a survey by contacting administrative officials of correctional and rehabilitative facilities where there are A.A. groups for a full assessment of A.A. in their facilities.
3. We update testimonials in "A.A. in Prisons" and "A.A. in Hospitals" as per information gathered from survey.
4. We change titles of institutional discount packages from: Men's Prison Package, Jail Package, Women's Prison Package, Hospital Package to: Discount Package A, B, C, etc., with contents of packages still indicated on order forms.
5. Simplified editions of "Memo to an Inmate" and "Is A.A. for You?" be prepared in an attempt to reach all levels of understanding.
6. It be noted that in the areas here represented, there was no problem with violations of the Seventh Tradition.
7. We cooperate with administrative officials in the institutional setting to the utmost within the confines of our Traditions and the suggestions contained in "A.A. in Prisons" and "Memo to an Inmate." If, because of prison procedure, inmates are encouraged to attend A.A. meetings, we have to assume that they're coming for the right reasons.
8. Any A.A. member's evaluating another A.A. member is totally in opposition to our Traditions.
9. The 1973 Conference reaffirm the action taken by the 1968 Conference on the use of the *World Directory*:

"That the present use of the *World Directory* in institutions be continued in order to provide immediate A.A. sponsorship for new members leaving the institution."

10. The next edition of the *Institutions Bulletin* include an article stressing careful use of the *World Directory* in institutions groups.

The committee elected Donald S. (Eastern Mass.) chairman, and John C. (Conn.) alternate chairman.

REPORT AND CHARTER

The committee recommended that:

1. Rough layouts of the 1973 Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference Report, and the new designations – "1973 General Service Conference Issue, Early Bird Edition" – added to the masthead of *Box 4-5-9* be approved.
2. The A.A.W.S. directors consider changing the name of the pamphlet "Bill on Alcoholism" to "Three Talks by Bill W. to Medical Societies," since the current title seems confusing and misleading to many readers.

3. Committee members act as news reporters to assist Janet and Barry in gathering news items for the Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference Report.
4. Committee members review and return the completed draft of the Conference Report one week after its receipt.
5. Certain updating, factual material, and terminology in "The A.A. Service Manual," and additional information respecting the delegate's term, as well as alternate, as recommended by the Agenda/Admissions Committee, be approved. (The new printing will be available some time this summer.)

The committee elected Ted K. (Wash.) chairman and Brick B. (S. Fla.) alternate chairman.

GRAPEVINE

The committee recommended that:

1. Reaffirming the 1962 action, retiring delegates become Grapevine Representatives (GvRs) and recruit other GvRs in their areas, with the objective of a GvR in each group.
2. Each Conference area select a Grapevine chairman who would create a structure to work with the groups to enhance the readership of the A.A. Grapevine.
3. No new Pay-as-You-Go groups be accepted after July 31, 1973, in view of increasing bad debts. Pay-as-You-Go groups in good standing, however, will be continued. We recommend Prepaid subscriptions.

The committee elected Bill H. (Cent. Mich.) chairman, and Jack C. (Utah) alternate chairman.

Other Advisory Actions

The 23rd General Service Conference also: (1) unanimously approved Utah's request for change from Southwest to Pacific Region; (2) elected Margaret C. (Western Mass.) General Service trustee, U.S., by a two-thirds majority. Further advisory actions appear – *boxed* – on the following pages: 9 (service activities of past delegates and newcomers); 11 (special purpose groups, election of delegates to World Service Meeting); 13 (election of regional trustees, *World Directory* guidelines and moratorium); 34 (Bill Wilson Memorial Fund).

DELEGATES-ONLY MEETING

Only area delegates to the 23rd Conference (other Conference members not present) met for dinner and discussion Friday evening, April 27. Sheila M. (S.W. Que.) was chairman, and Sheila later offered the following report to the entire Conference.

1. It was the sense of the meeting that:
 - A. Delegates should be more responsive to G.S.O. requests and communications.
 - B. Present delegates should be more thorough in advice to successors on Conference structure, activity, procedures.

(cont. on next page)

DELEGATES-ONLY (cont.)

C. That G.S.O. might improve lines of communication to delegates in such matters as attitudes on Conference theme and seek attitudes on finalized agenda/subject matter.

It was also requested that delegates be advised of the results of the 1972 "Conference Evaluation and Critique Study."

2. Delegates recommended that the agenda of the 24th Conference include in-depth discussion concerning involvement of A.A. members in outside-agency programs on alcoholism—suggestion made with view in mind that the new Professional Relations Committee would be deeply involved in this matter, particularly to determine whether or not such involvement results in implied endorsement in violation of our Traditions.

3. Recommended delegate chairman be more actively involved in Conference—such as introducing delegate highlight speakers, introducing Conference committee chairmen making reports—and chairing meetings involving delegates.

4. Don P. (Colo.) was elected delegate chairman and Al B. (B.C./Yukon), alternate chairman.

5. Ben P. made a brief report on the World Service Meeting and strongly recommended delegates read and examine the report and election procedures before Saturday-afternoon voting.

6. Following a lengthy and well-rounded discussion of all shades of opinion, a motion was made, seconded, and passed that the Conference reconsider the tabling action of the Bill W. Memorial Fund, and, further, the sense of the meeting was that the money be placed in the General Fund as expeditiously as possible.

Conference Advisory Action

The 23rd General Service Conference unanimously recommended that the money in the Bill Wilson Memorial Fund be transferred to the General Fund as expeditiously as possible.

ASK-IT-BASKET

(cont. from p. 15)

SERVICE STRUCTURE

Q. In dividing an area into districts, is it better to have enough districts so that a committee member serves 10-15 groups? Or do you prefer having fewer districts with multiple committee members to serve the groups?

A. Sense of the meeting: One committee member serving 10-15 groups would be less unwieldy.

Q. How do you feel about combining local and General Service into one committee to serve both?

A. Show of hands indicated that most areas keep them separate.

Q. In what order does G.S.O. suggest committee chairmen serve — before or after serving as a delegate?

A. This is a local decision.

Q. If we really believe and practice principles before personalities — if we have come of age — why is a two-thirds vote necessary for state chairman, delegate, etc.?

A. We have a two-thirds majority in order to have substantial unanimity. A simple majority would leave almost half unhappy.

Q. In the Guidelines pertaining to members who "wear two hats," it is suggested that members who do wear two hats not hold group office. Would this suggestion also apply to members holding offices at the assembly level? That is, that A.A.'s who wear two hats should not hold offices such as delegate, chairman of the assembly, treasurer, secretary, or committee member?

A. The Guidelines for members who wear two hats simply represent the experience and suggestions of the A.A. members who responded to questions asked by G.S.O. In other words, this seemed to be the consensus among them. However, the Conference Com-

mittee on Trustees and the Trustees' Nominating Committee agreed in 1966 that employment in the field of alcoholism should not preclude a qualified A.A. member from consideration as a trustee candidate, so one could extend that to serving in other capacities.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Q. What is the difference between public information work and promotion in our Fellowship?

A. From the Public Information Policy of the G.S. Board's P.I. Committee: "A traditional public relations policy based on 'attraction' carries with it certain definite implications. First, we can't attract people who have never heard of us. Second, unless what is printed or broadcast about A.A. is based on accurate information, our message can be made to appear quite unattractive. Thus, the P.I. Committee has the twofold responsibility of creating increased public understanding of the A.A. program and preventing *misunderstanding* of the Fellowship. . . . We do not court publicity for its own sake, but seek only to provide media with a fair and accurate image of A.A. which they can transmit to the public and to the millions of sick alcoholics who need our help and who can be attracted to ask for it some day, God willing."

WORLD DIRECTORY

Q. One group in my area wants to know why the *World Directory* is not made into a meeting list with meeting places and times listed, plus the group contacts and phone numbers as now listed.

A. The *World Directory* is a contact list, not a meeting list. Almost all areas have their own meeting lists. The size of the *Directory* would become unwieldy if all this information was included for each group.

Q. What is your opinion about listing group

contributions in the *World Directory* and special contributions in *Box 4-5-9*?

A. Conference overwhelmingly in favor of listing these.

ANONYMITY

Q. A prospective juror was being questioned by the district attorney. The D.A. asked him if he was a member of A.A. How should this have been answered? (There may have been members of the press present.)

A. We cannot ask anyone to refuse to obey the law. The juror can advise the D.A. in advance, before being questioned by the attorneys, and hope that his anonymity is respected.

Q. What is the feeling on a central office secretary's letting his name be used on the letterhead of an outside agency?

A. Should not, if he is identified there as an A.A. member.

CLUBS

Q. May a club run a service office for alcoholics?

A. Experience proves that intergroup or central offices or central service committees should be separate from clubs — physically separate and separate as far as administration is concerned. In some cases, a newly formed intergroup or central office is invited to use club facilities. At that point, A.A.'s should take a good look at traditions and remember that a service office is responsible to all A.A., while a club is the responsibility of the dues-paying members only. Generous as the offer may appear, a service office is well advised to maintain its own quarters and its own officers.

Q. May a club sponsor a group?

A. Since a club is for social activities, to sponsor a group might be confusing and indicate an alliance.

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1972

	<u>1972</u>	<u>1971</u>
INCOME		
Net Sales, after Book Discounts waived of \$62,397 in 1972 and \$51,775 in 1971	\$ 830,347	\$ 672,099
Less: Cost of Printing	244,472	204,126
Royalties	89,396	74,098
Gross Profit from Literature	496,479	393,875
Contributions – A.A. Groups and Members	564,334	498,849
Interest Income	2,054	–
<u>Total Income</u>	1,062,867	892,724
EXPENSES		
Salaries	510,157	448,690
Rent	50,747	49,704
Office Construction Costs	9,194	1,950
Box 4-5-9	23,569	19,401
World Directory	37,559	28,787
Other Service Office Printing	25,397	14,338
Shipping and Mailing	95,148	80,850
Other Office Expenses	90,364	72,774
Insurance and Taxes	40,433	37,969
Professional Services	13,880	14,375
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	18,451	19,699
1972 World Meeting	14,747	–
Writing, Research	1,882	2,346
P.I.C., P.R.C., Travel	13,410	17,421
General Service Conference	39,417	34,656
Communications – Bill's death	–	11,117
Foreign Literature Aid	898	1,618
Film, Filmstrip, Display Boards	4,144	3,157
<u>Total Expense</u>	989,397	858,852
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>73,470</u>	<u>33,872</u>

NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION

Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 190,881	\$ 115,174
General Fund – General Service Board	(117,411)	(81,302)
CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS – 1972		
	<u>Pension</u>	<u>Reserve</u>
Balance, January 1, 1972	\$ 3,175	\$271,593
Book Discounts	62,397	
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	3,500	
Investment Income	476	18,303
Contributions Received		2,073
Refundable Subscriptions		700
General Fund Contribution		
Less: Current Funding Costs	(53,339)	
Actuary Fee	(3,048)	
Balance, December 31, 1972	<u>13,161</u>	<u>289,896</u>
		<u>39,755</u>
		<u>14,036</u>

() Denotes red figures.

Amounts in these financial statements under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 – by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts – for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND, which was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the benefit of employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. prior to transfer to the Trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1972

	1972	1971
INCOME - FROM SUBSCRIPTIONS AND OTHER SALES	<u>\$289,373</u>	<u>\$263,464</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries	\$ 41,924	\$ 39,746
Printing	65,166	60,827
Mailing - Service	27,601	28,541
Postage	2,025	5,060
Other printing costs	3,667	3,057
Calendar costs	10,198	8,913
Best Cartoons	1,053	1,707
Rent	6,594	6,656
Telephone	1,324	1,223
Office supplies and expense	2,305	1,894
Other editorial expenses	2,939	3,058
Office cleaning	<u>1,041</u>	<u>1,032</u>
Total	<u>165,837</u>	<u>161,714</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	52,729	47,950
Stationery and supplies	2,565	3,490
Rent	6,594	6,656
Telephone	1,324	1,216
Other office expense	1,101	427
Selling expense	7,524	10,099
Postage	7,294	6,465
Office cleaning	1,040	1,032
Bad debts	<u>1,129</u>	<u>892</u>
Total	<u>81,300</u>	<u>78,227</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	3,204	3,275
Legal and accounting	7,215	4,100
Taxes	6,426	4,675
Meetings and conferences	540	660
Furniture and equipment	-	340
Contribution to Retirement Plan	<u>3,500</u>	<u>3,500</u>
Total	<u>20,885</u>	<u>16,550</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>268,022</u>	<u>256,491</u>
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	21,351	6,973
Add: Interest on savings accounts	<u>9,430</u>	<u>8,818</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>30,781</u>	<u>15,791</u>

(continued from p. 35)

The MEMORIAL FUND, which was established in 1971 to receive contributions from A.A. groups and members in memory of Bill W. The funds have been deposited in separate savings accounts until such time as the General Service Conference authorizes their expenditure for a suitable memorial or purpose.

The CONVENTION GUARANTY FUND was established in 1972 by subscriptions from A.A. members in Colorado, and by a transfer from the General Fund for the purpose of making up a deficit, if any, incurred in connection with the Convention to be held in Denver in 1975. To the extent not so used it is to be refunded to the original subscribers.

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed. In 1972 the Conference approved the consolidation of the GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND with the GENERAL FUND. The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND had been established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Conference.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1972

	December 31, 1972		December 31, 1971	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash	\$102,386	\$ 53,373	\$191,504	\$ 52,242
Savings accounts and certificates	127,049	9,354	-	16,416
Marketable securities	-	125,169	-	100,419
Accounts receivable	55,406	13,163	18,375	9,210
Quebec General Service Committee	3,913	-	7,864	-
Due from Grapevine	2,000	-	12,000	-
Inventories	169,300	8,722	130,200	8,317
Prepaid expenses	21,287	5,860	17,913	5,390
Total Assets	481,341	215,641	377,856	191,994
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	60,674	8,372	36,696	19,768
Due Pension Fund	4,444	-	3,907	-
Prepaid subscriptions, unearned income	-	136,122	-	119,860
Reserve for Retirement Plan payments	-	7,000	-	7,000
Total Liabilities	65,118	151,494	40,603	146,628
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	337,253	45,366	291,381	41,575
Net Income for Year (Exhibits A and B)	73,470	30,781	33,872	15,791
Contribution (paid) or received	12,000	(12,000)	12,000	(12,000)
Transfer to Convention Fund	(6,500)	-	-	-
Total Net Worth	\$416,223	64,147	337,253	45,366
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing - A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$329,539		\$238,658	
General Fund - G.S.B. (Note A)	86,684		98,595	
Total Operating Funds - as above	416,223		337,253	
Reserve Fund	289,896		271,593	
Deferred Pension Fund	13,161		3,175	
Memorial Fund	39,755		36,982	
Convention Guaranty Fund	14,036		-	
Total Net Worth	773,071		649,003	
RESERVE, DEFERRED PENSION, MEMORIAL AND CONVENTION GUARANTY FUNDS	Reserve	Pension	Memorial	Convention
Cash	\$ 559			
Savings accounts and certificates	25,548	\$ 21,176	\$ 36,686	\$ 14,036
Due from A.A.W.S. and Grapevine		5,319		
U.S. Treasury obligations	170,067			
Government Agency and Corporate Bonds	89,320			
Accrued interest	4,402		3,069	
Less: Due Retirement Trust		(13,334)		
Balance, December 31	289,896	13,161	39,755	14,036

() Denotes red figures.

(continued from p. 36)

In these statements, the net worth and net operating results of A.A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing.

NOTE A - After transfers of \$100,000 in 1972 and 1971 from Publishing to General Fund.

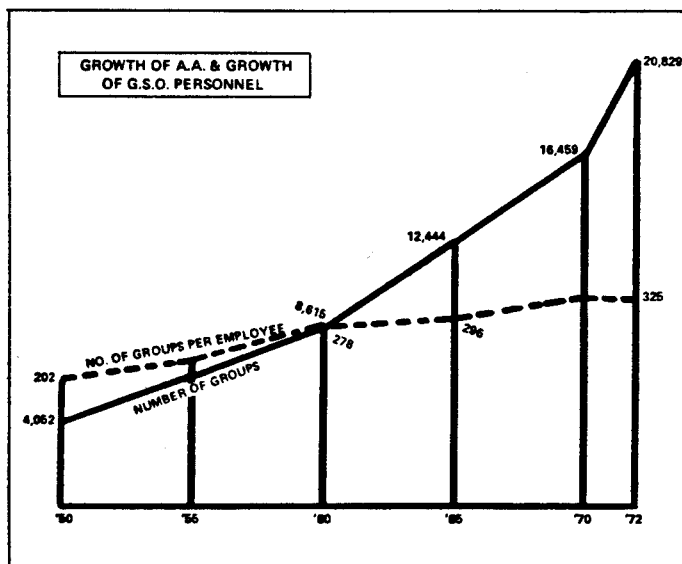
These financial statements and notes have been prepared by the independent certified public accountants from the figures contained in their reports on the three separate corporations.

Growth & Money at G.S.O.

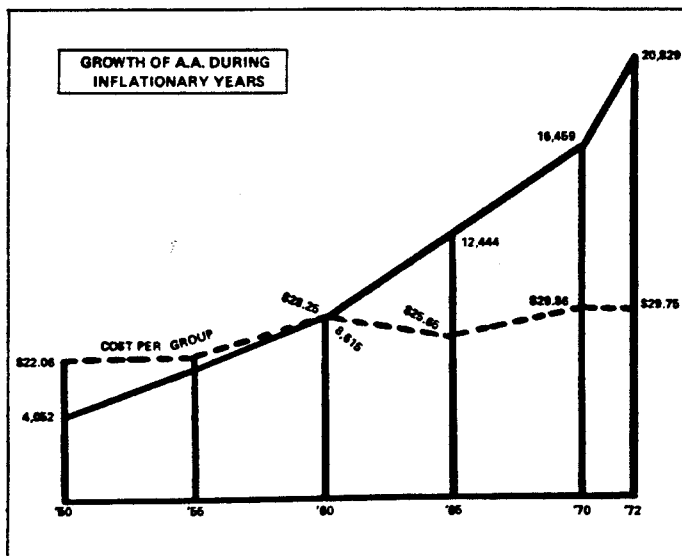
How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel – in 1950 there was one employee for each 202 groups. Today, one employee serves each 325 groups.

During the past twenty-two years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$89,500 to \$619,800 for group services. During that same period, cost of living increased 79%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per group actually showed a decrease from \$22.06 to \$16.66.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Cost
1950	4,052	20	202	\$22.06	100
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	107
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	119
1965	12,444	42	296	25.65	126
1970	16,459	50	329	29.86	159
1972	20,829	64	325	29.75	179



1. (Above) There are more than 5 times as many groups today as in 1950. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 325 groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 202 in 1950.



2. (Above) During the years 1950 through 1972, the cost of living increased 79 percent. Constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per group to \$29.75 in 1972 compared with \$22.06 in 1950, an increase of only 35 percent.

1973 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1973 Operations of G.S.O. activities – exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine – is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. – PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$958,500*
Less: Cost of Products	393,000
Gross Profit from Sales	565,500

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	222,800
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*Based upon the sale of:

97,400 Books – "Alcoholics Anonymous"

37,400 Books – "12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Reg.)

12,300 Books – "12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Pocket)

11,100 Books – "A.A. Comes of Age"

17,400 Books – "As Bill Sees It" and

Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$620,800
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TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	(64,300)
----------------------------	----------

**Includes cost of General Service Conference – \$40,400

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 4,000
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TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of Income (Expense)	(48,700)
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***Board Meetings, P.I.C. Expense, F.R.C. Expense and Special Projects.

The Publishing activity will contribute \$113,000 to offset the budgeted deficits.

1973 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales.....	\$309,400
Estimated Expense.....	303,400

Net income from operations.....	6,000
Interest from investments.....	9,500

Net Income.....	15,500
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1972 Group Contributions

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita	CANADA	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alabama	111	55	49.5%	17	30.9%	3,430.36	1,561	\$ 2.20	Alberta	199	95	47.7	7	7.4	\$ 5,204.65	1,833	\$ 2.84
Alaska	31	21	67.7	5	23.8	905.00	318	2.85	Atlantic Provinces								
Arizona	199	100	50.2	22	22.0	5,846.04	2,325	2.51	New Brunswick	67	38	56.7	7	18.4	1,442.62	759	1.90
Arkansas	88	53	60.2	15	28.3	2,423.50	1,160	2.09	Newfoundland	19	10	55.6	—	—	533.65	208	2.60
California	1,780	1,011	56.8	373	36.9	63,884.70	40,456	1.58	Nova Scotia	79	48	60.8	9	18.8	2,023.53	922	2.19
Colorado	191	110	57.6	42	38.2	6,314.38	3,051	2.07	Prince Ed. Is.	24	12	50.0	1	8.3	613.69	344	1.78
Connecticut	298	163	54.7	48	29.4	13,638.55	5,011	2.72	British Columbia	264	152	57.6	33	21.7	9,773.79	3,363	2.91
Delaware	45	33	73.3	12	36.4	1,892.00	600	3.15	Manitoba	64	46	71.9	5	10.9	3,586.35	1,318	2.72
Dist. of Columbia	70	38	54.3	24	63.2	5,463.25	1,954	2.80	N.W. Territories	7	4	57.1	—	—	112.79	47	2.40
Florida	437	260	59.5	116	44.6	30,102.90	7,001	4.30	Ontario	564	369	65.4	144	39.0	31,231.92	8,196	3.81
Georgia	193	149	77.2	61	40.9	6,460.52	2,943	2.20	Quebec	602	353	58.6	142	40.2	12,937.15	14,067	.92
Hawaii	45	28	62.2	8	28.6	1,331.40	639	2.08	Saskatchewan	139	84	60.4	9	10.7	4,207.17	1,617	2.60
Idaho	53	34	64.2	7	20.6	1,184.37	545	2.17	Yukon Terr.	3	2	66.7	—	—	42.00	66	.64
Illinois	821	430	42.0	124	28.8	19,030.30	13,069	1.46	TOTAL for CANADA	2,031	1,213	59.7%	357	29.4%	\$ 71,709.31	32,740	\$ 2.19
Indiana	236	145	61.4	54	37.2	12,095.64	3,452	3.50	TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	14,168	8,440	59.6%	3,163	37.5%	\$557,826.55	244,426	\$ 2.28
Iowa	159	91	57.2	25	27.4	6,026.50	2,807	2.15	FOREIGN & OTHER								
Kansas	149	102	68.5	35	34.3	5,687.04	2,757	2.06	Foreign						2,866.30		
Kentucky	153	97	63.4	25	25.8	7,692.21	1,787	4.30	World Hello						—		
Louisiana	126	79	62.7	23	29.1	3,683.20	2,184	1.69	International Doctors						304.00		
Maine	65	49	75.4	17	34.7	2,759.60	807	3.42	Hospital Groups						2,216.04		
Maryland	243	164	67.5	63	38.4	10,065.99	3,451	2.92	Prison Groups						355.85		
Massachusetts	373	205	55.0	88	42.9	14,324.89	7,359	1.95	Internationalists						953.45		
Michigan	448	280	62.5	129	46.1	25,581.27	7,308	3.50	Young People in A.A.						—		
Minnesota	343	301	87.8	63	20.9	12,052.98	9,935	1.21	Amateur Radio						44.00		
Mississippi	63	33	52.4	12	36.4	1,447.00	882	1.64	International Deaf						6.00		
Missouri	252	139	55.2	48	34.5	7,351.63	3,531	2.08	GRAND TOTAL						\$564,572.19		
Montana	81	42	51.9	17	40.5	1,509.95	866	1.74									
Nebraska	113	66	58.4	29	43.9	3,777.97	1,645	2.30									
Nevada	65	34	52.3	17	50.0	2,335.00	1,196	1.95									
New Hampshire	68	41	60.2	15	36.6	1,885.00	1,013	1.86									
New Jersey	375	236	62.9	121	51.3	19,888.95	6,134	3.24									
New Mexico	70	43	61.4	18	41.9	2,718.08	992	2.74									
New York	837	502	60.0	258	51.4	43,951.96	15,258	2.88									
North Carolina	231	157	68.0	60	38.2	9,423.65	3,186	2.96									
North Dakota	73	41	56.1	11	26.8	2,332.50	816	2.86									
Ohio	637	299	46.9	92	30.8	16,672.52	11,825	1.41									
Oklahoma	126	106	84.1	67	22.4	7,361.75	1,590	4.63									
Oregon	152	75	49.3	39	52.0	4,140.87	1,726	2.40									
Pennsylvania	434	294	67.7	138	46.9	25,152.04	7,527	3.34									
Rhode Island	52	31	59.6	15	48.4	3,214.75	736	4.37									
South Carolina	90	53	58.9	28	52.8	3,341.25	1,370	2.44	U.S.A. 1972	12,137	7,227	59.5%	2,806	38.8%	\$486,117.24	211,686	\$ 2.30
South Dakota	60	28	46.7	10	35.7	1,917.70	1,005	1.91	U.S.A. 1971	10,345	6,734	65.1	2,297	34.1	436,434.43	181,499	2.41
Tennessee	131	62	47.3	22	35.5	3,330.00	1,870	1.78	Increase				509	4.7%			
Texas	499	260	52.1	115	44.2	18,922.44	11,538	1.64	(Decrease)	1,792	493	(5.6)%			49,682.81	30,187	(.11)
Utah	73	40	54.8	16	40.0	1,786.17	969	1.84	Canada 1972	2,031	1,213	59.7%	357	29.4%	\$ 71,709.31	32,740	\$ 2.19
Vermont	48	31	64.6	7	22.6	2,706.97	542	4.99	Canada 1971	1,815	1,061	58.5	232	21.8	57,158.49	29,073	1.97
Virginia	216	156	72.2	78	50.0	11,145.01	3,407	3.27	Increase				125	7.6%			
Washington	245	172	70.2	82	47.7	13,134.66	3,132	4.19	(Decrease)	216	152	1.2%			14,550.82	3,667	.22
West Virginia	80	50	62.5	24	48.0	2,698.40	924	2.92	U.S. &								
Wisconsin	327	192	58.7	53	27.6	9,277.24	4,277	2.17	Canada 1972	14,168	8,440	59.6%	3,163	37.5%	\$557,826.55	244,226	\$ 2.28
Wyoming	31	18	58.1	4	22.2	625.55	357	1.75	U.S. &								
Commonwealth of P.R.	39	24	61.5	10	41.7	1,565.64	714	2.19	Canada 1971	12,160	7,795	64.1	2,529	32.4	493,592.92	210,552	2.35
Canal Zone	2	2	100.0	2	100.0	550.00	62	8.87	Increase								
Bahama Islands	5	—	0	1	100.0	15.00	66	—	(Decrease)	2,008	645	(4.5)%	634	5.1%	\$64,233.63	33,674	\$ (.07)
Virgin Islands																	
of U.S.	5	2	40.0	1	50.0	61.00	50	1.22									
Total for U.S.	12,137	7,227	59.5%	2,806	38.8%	\$486,117.24	211,686	\$ 2.30									

enough, care enough, and participate enough in this Conference, it could be the most productive to date. You have a responsibility to speak out, loud and clear.

Panels 21 and 22 indicated delegates wished to play a more active role in the Conference. G.S.O. and the Conference Agenda Committee have been responsive to these suggestions. With two unstructured workshops, a Sharing Session on workshop topics, and the popular Ask-It-Basket, this Conference certainly offers the opportunity to participate. Take advantage of it. Certainly, your area elected you as delegate to listen and learn; but they also elected you to share your area's experience and concern by participating—by speaking out, loud and clear. Are we, as elected representatives of over a half-million A.A. members, willing to express our gratitude by taking the responsibility of speaking out?

We refer to the "voice of the group conscience," but we must be responsible to see it is an *informed* group conscience. What about the most important link in our structure — the G.S.R.? The G.S.R. is the link between G.S.O. and the group. We must see that each group has an *informed* G.S.R. His responsibility, his expression of gratitude, is to keep his group informed of A.A. experience at the committee, delegate, trustee, and G.S.O. levels. His responsibility, his expression of gratitude, is to keep his committee, his delegate, his trustees, and G.S.O. informed when the voice of his group's conscience speaks.

It is our responsibility, our expression of gratitude, to see we have the best available G.S.R.'s. Tom G., at last year's

Conference, asked: "If we agree that this Conference needs and must have the best obtainable delegates, how can we assume *that* if we do not have the best available people as committee members and G.S.R.'s?"

Another very important reason for participation is our spiritual needs. As Bill says in the 4th Concept, all of us deeply desire to *belong*. We want an A.A. relation of brotherly partnership. It is our spiritual responsibility that no one, *no one* in A.A. is ever regarded as "second class." The rights of appeal and petition, of course, aim at protecting and making use of minority feeling and opinion. I say use these rights; speak out loud and clear.

The 12 Concepts are an interpretation of A.A.'s world service structure. Each A.A. member, after we have found sobriety, is faced with immense responsibilities: for our own growth and development, for the welfare of our group and A.A. as a whole, and for better relations with the world around us. A.A. is not judged by its literature or its use of public relations techniques. A.A. will be judged by its own attractive examples, not only as alcoholics who have learned to live a life without the use of alcohol or pills, but as human beings. If these examples are not good, *any* publicity is too much, and dangerous.

Thank you for allowing me to participate. I look forward to this 23rd Conference contributing more to the growth of the structure of our Fellowship than any other to date.

—Jack M., Michigan
East Central trustee

CLOSING BRUNCH

A spirit of warm comradeship, only slightly tinged with regret that it was almost all over, pervaded the Terrace Room of the Hotel Roosevelt for the final Conference session Sunday morning.

Trustees Niles P. and Steve O., departing from the G.S. Board, spoke eloquently and briefly after brunch, followed by an A.A. meeting with delegates Dick D. (W. Mass.), LaVelle C. (N.W. Tex.), and Chuck B. (San Diego, Calif.) as speakers.

Dr. Jack, Bob, and area delegate chairman Sheila M. (S.W. Que.) thanked the Conference Secretary and others for their work in making the 23rd Conference a success.

INSTITUTIONS (cont. from p. 7)

A.A. in Correctional Institutions

The A.A. group I belong to started A.A. in Canadian prisons in Dorchester Federal Prison in 1948. I am the third sponsor of this group during the past 25 years, a sponsorship handed to me over eight years ago. With the establishment of our Trustees' Institutions Committee this year, and through the G.S.O. Institutions staff member, we are in a better position really to share our experiences.

I was deeply moved when we stood hand in hand at the Toronto Conference in 1965 and accepted the pledge of responsibility. This pledge really fits the needs of those unfortunates in jail or prison. An institutions sponsor is responsible for presenting the A.A. message to institution heads, classification departments, guidance counselors, and anyone else taken up with rehabilitation. It is important these people be properly informed of our motives, and of what A.A. actually is.

We must abide by the institution's rules. Maybe institution groups cannot operate as we do on the outside. In prisons, they have roll calls, use last names and numbers—quite unlike a typical outside meeting. However, once the meeting is in progress, a group can and should operate under the principle of anonymity.

The greatest strength of an institution group is not necessarily contained in the Twelve Steps, but more in the Twelve Traditions. Try to place principles before personalities in a prison society with its caste system—led by the lifers, down to the "lowest form" of prison life, the rapist or child-molester. In prisons, usually each knows what the other is in for. It is hard to overcome the prison code in an A.A. meeting, but overcome it we must and do. Even the most hardened criminals have respect for A.A., even though they are suspicious of our motives. When they recognize success, then they come forward.

Seventy-two percent of inmates have alcohol problems, we are told, and many, on release, go back to drinking. So it is important that members of an institution group be put in touch with a sponsor *before* release, if they are going to have a chance at all. Recently, the members in our prison group put it to me this way: "I'm entitled to a good drunk and a good woman, and *then* I'll go to A.A." (I talk of men's prisons, and possibly the woman inmate does not think too differently.) It is up to you and me to sponsor these members on the street and take them to their first outside meetings. Then they can make up their own minds, sober, as to their priorities.

Institutions correspondence service offers hope to members in prisons. This kind of Twelfth Step work is appreciated, and we hope it will be continued.

Some members cannot or will not become involved in institutions activities. Some groups are not all that happy when members of prison groups are taken to their meetings. This is indeed unfortunate. But A.A. will work even in overcoming the masked exterior of the hard-rock con. We need your help to bring about these changes. Have you accepted your responsibility in extending the hand of A.A.?

—Bob G., New Brunswick/Prince Edward
Island, chairman,
Conference Institutions Committee

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NONALCOHOLIC (Class A) TRUSTEES

JOHN L. NORRIS, M.D., Box 251, New London, N.H. 03257. "Dr. Jack" is chairman of the General Service Board and of the General Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January 1951. Before his retirement, he was associate medical director of Eastman Kodak Co., Rochester, N.Y. He is former chairman of the N.Y. Governor's Committee on Alcoholism, former president of the Industrial Medicine Association and of the American Academy of Occupational Medicine. He chairs the Board's Long-Range Planning Committee, serves on the Nominating Committee, and is an *ex-officio* member of all Trustees' committees.

JOHN D. BEALER, M.D., 3639 Emerson Circle, Bethlehem, Pa. 18017. Elected to the Board in April 1971, "Dr. John" is assistant medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corporation. He has long been interested in the problem of alcoholism in industry and is a member of the American Medical Society on Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism. He serves on the Trustees' Policy, Finance and Budgetary, and Professional Relations Committees.

TRAVIS E. DANCEY, M.D., 4015 Wilson Ave., Montreal 28, Que., Canada. Elected to the Board in January 1965, Dr. Dancey was, before his partial retirement, chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital. Now he is senior psychiatrist at Montreal General Hospital and associate professor at McGill University. A good friend of A.A. since the formation of the first A.A. group in Quebec, Dr. Dancey is the first nonalcoholic trustee from Canada. He serves on the Trustees' Policy and Professional Relations Committees.

VINCENT P. DOLE, M.D., Rockefeller University, 67 St. and York Ave., New York, N.Y. 10021. Elected to the Board in April 1965, Dr. Dole is professor and senior physician at the Rockefeller University Hospital. Dr. Dole developed a method used in treatment of narcotic addiction and is active in many professional organizations dealing with addiction. He serves on the Trustees' Policy Committee.

AUSTIN H. MacCORMICK, Osborne Association, Inc., 114 East 30 St., New York, N.Y. 10016. Elected to the Board in April 1961, he is now its first vice-chairman. He had served on the Board previously, from October 1949 to April 1951, but left in 1951 to become professor of criminology at the University of California in Berkeley. On his retirement in 1960, he returned to New York as executive director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He serves on both Corporate and Editorial Boards of the A.A. Grapevine, as a member of the Trustees' Nominating Committee, and as chairman of the Trustees' new Institutions Committee.

MILTON A. MAXWELL, Ph.D., 86 Mitchell Ave., Piscataway, N.J. 08854. Elected to the Board in April 1971, he is executive director of the Summer School of Alcohol Studies and professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics and Alcoholics Anonymous. Recent research focused on the relations between professionals and A.A. He serves on the Trustees' Long-Range Planning, Policy, and Professional Relations Committees.

ARTHUR J. MILES, 212 Poplar St., Floral Park, N.Y. 11001. Elected to the Board in April 1970, he is a senior vice-president and treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of New York and is on the Board of Trustees of the American Institute of Banking and the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. Treasurer of the General Service Board, he also serves as chairman of its Finance and Budgetary and its Employee Retirement Committees.

*Members of Conference other than area delegates

ALCOHOLIC (Class B) TRUSTEES

RALPH W. AHRINGER, 73 Plymouth Dr. N., Glen Head, N.Y. 11543. Elected to the Board in April 1971 and elected chairman and president of the Grapevine Corporate Board in April 1972, Ralph serves on the Trustees' Literature, Nominating, and Policy Committees. He had his last drink in 1954. He was formerly delegate (Panel 13) to the General Service Conference, chairman and treasurer of the S.E. N.Y. General Service Committee, and president of New York Intergroup. Most recently, he was chairman of the Intergroup Advisory Committee. He is married, and is advertising manager of Sabin Robbins Paper Company.

JUNIOR ANDERSON, 31 LaSalle Rd., Needham Heights, Mass. 02194. Elected regional trustee from the Northeast U.S. in 1972, Junior has been sober 15 years and involved in group and area A.A. activities since 1958, including service as a Conference delegate (Panel 19). He is still active as a speaker both inside and outside A.A., was chairman of his state convention (1969-70) and of the First Northeast Region Convention (1971). He is sales representative of the Otis Elevator Co., for which he has worked 35 years. Married, he has four daughters. He serves on the Trustees' Policy and Nominating Committees.

DONALD G. AUSTIN, P.O. Drawer 1, Chappell Hill Farm, Chappell Hill, Tex. 77426. Elected to the Board from the Southwest region in April 1971, Donald had his last drink in 1953. He is a former chairman of the Texas State A.A. Convention and committee member from the Southwest Texas area. He is also chairman of the Texas Commission on Alcoholism, and a member of the Board of the Houston Council on Alcoholism. He serves on the Trustees' Finance and Budgetary, Institutions, Policy, and Professional Relations Committees.

***MARGARET J. CARLSON**, 218 Regency Park Dr., Agawam, Mass. 01001. Elected General Service trustee, U.S. at the 1973 Conference, Margaret has been sober since early in 1959. Graduated from the University of Rochester, she attended the Rutgers Center of Alcohol Studies. She was Conference delegate (Mass., West) on Panel 20 and later served on the first Northeast Region Convention Committee. Margaret has had extensive industrial experience and currently is administrator of an alcoholism agency in Springfield. She is a golfer and is active in the Lutheran Church.

GEORGE N. GORDON, Ph.D., 110-15 71 Rd., Forest Hills, N.Y. 11375. Elected General Service trustee in April 1972, he began serving after the July Board meeting. A director of the Grapevine, he has been its treasurer since 1970. Since his last drink in 1964, he has served his local group in most offices, as well as serving on several committees of N.Y. Intergroup. He is presently director of the Communications Center at Hofstra University in Hempstead, N.Y. He is married and the author or co-author of numerous works, including 13 nonfiction books, 11 of them written after joining our Fellowship. He serves as chairman of the Trustees' Literature Committee, co-chairman of Finance and Budgetary, and on the Long-Range Planning, Policy, and Employee Retirement Committees.

THOMAS D. GRAFTON, 1 Iroquois Bay, St. Boniface 6, Man., Canada. Elected to the Board as General Service trustee, Canada, April 1971, Tom had his last drink in 1960 and is active in institutions, intergroup, and Third Legacy work. He is a former delegate (Panel 18) from Manitoba, and former chairman of the Manitoba G.S. Committee. A member of the legal firm of Grafton and Company, Tom belongs to the Canadian and Manitoba Bar Associations. He is chairman of the Trustees' Policy Committee, and also serves on its Nominating and Institutions Committees.

(cont. on next page)

*New trustee

ROSTER

ALCOHOLIC (Class B) TRUSTEES (cont.)

JAMES G. GRIFFIN, 302 S. Jefferson, North Platte, Nebr. 69101. Elected regional trustee from the West Central U.S. region in 1972, Jim has been sober 21 years. He has served as a G.S.R., area committee member, chairman of his state committee, and Conference delegate (Panel 18). He attends A.A. functions in surrounding states, is active in local groups, and has helped to start a number of them. He owns and pilots his own plane, is married, and has had a successful career for 16 years in the insurance business. He serves on the Trustees' Policy and Literature Committees.

GEORGE GRIMSTAD, 2636 N. 48 Dr., Phoenix, Ariz. 85035. Elected to the Board from the Pacific region in April 1971, George was a delegate (Panel 11) from Chicago, Ill., before moving to Arizona. He was one of the founders of the General Service Committee and intergroup in Chicago, and had his last drink in 1950. He is coordinator for the A.S.A.P. program at St. Luke's Hospital, Phoenix, and a director for Northern Arizona Recovery Centers. He serves on the Trustees' Policy, Institutions, and Nominating Committees.

JACK R. MEAGHER, 1015 Whites Rd., Kalamazoo, Mich. 49008. Jack had his last drink in 1949, and was elected to the Board from the East Central region in April 1971. A former delegate (Panel 6) from Western Michigan, Jack also served as chairman of his state conference and the Western Michigan G.S. Committee. He is director of the Computer Center and professor of computer science and mathematics at Western Michigan University. He serves on the Trustees' Finance and Budgetary and Policy Committees.

TOM W. MOORE, Box 458, Pulaski, Tenn. 38478. Tom had his last drink in 1950, and was elected to the Board in April 1971, from the Southeast region. He was formerly delegate (Panel 18) from Tennessee, as well as chairman of his state committee. He is senior partner of Moore, Henry, Henry, Lewis & Cain, and past president of Pulaski-Giles County Bar Association. He is a trustee for a college and for a charitable institution. Co-chairman of the Trustees' Policy Committee, he also serves on the Institutions and Nominating Committees.

****WALTER J. MURPHY**, 401 E. 81st St., New York, N.Y. 10028. Sober 13 years, Walter was elected at the April 1973 Board meeting, replacing Niles Peebles, who resigned to join G.S.O. staff. Walter has been a public relations professional with a broadcast network and an advertising agency and currently heads his own P.R. firm. He was chairman of the Lenox Hill Group and is chairman of the Trustees' Public Information Committee. Outside A.A., he has served on several governmental and voluntary committees on alcoholism.

MATT NEWELL, 1014 Prospect Ave. S.W., Calgary 3, Alta., Canada. Elected as regional trustee from Western Canada in 1972, Matt has been sober 23 years. In 1950, he started the first group in Chadron, Nebr. He has been past provincial secretary for Alberta and in 1952 organized beginners meetings in Calgary. Outside A.A., Matt is director of the Alcoholism Foundation of Alberta, a member of the Advisory Board of the Department of Health of the province, and a current member of the Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission of Alberta. He is president of Spruce Oils, Ltd., and is married. He serves on the Trustees' Policy and Professional Relations Committees.

STEPHEN C. OWEN, Sr., 229 Hollywood Crossing, Cedarhurst, N.Y. 11516. Elected to the Board in April 1969, Steve began serving the end of July that year. He had his last drink in 1960, and has served in various jobs in his home group on Long Island. He was N.Y. Intergroup treasurer 1962-63. He retired in 1968 from Beacon Manufacturing Co., a textile firm, and is currently president of Sirocco Co., an investment firm, and director of other companies as well. He is chairman of A.A.W.S., Inc., chairman of the Trustees' Professional Relations Committee, co-chairman of its Literature Committee, and a member of the Policy and Employee Retirement Committees.

ROBERT ROY, 75 Marengere St., Apt. 6, Hull, Que., Canada. Bob had his last drink in 1959, and was elected to the Board in April 1971, from

****New trustee**

Eastern Canada. A former delegate (Panel 14) from Quebec, he is a co-founder of *La Vigne*, French-language magazine for A.A. members, and was chairman of the Quebec G.S. Committee, as well as secretary of Montreal Intergroup. He is an auditor in the Audit Services Bureau, Government of Canada. Bob serves on the Trustees' Policy, Literature, and Finance and Budgetary Committees.

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Valerie Seyffert, secretary

What Do Panel Numbers Mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 23rd Conference is made up of Panel 22 - the even delegates - and Panel 23 - the new delegates.

STATE

PANEL

- | | |
|------------------------|--|
| ALABAMA & N.W. FLORIDA | (23) Gerald Hicks, 307 E. Mountain Avenue, Jacksonville, Alabama 36365 |
| ALASKA | (22) Guy Kelley, 2807½ W. 30th, Anchorage, Alaska 99503 |
| ARIZONA | (22) *S. W. (Bill) Slover, Jr., 5815 S. 36th, Phoenix, Arizona 85040 |
| ARKANSAS | (23) Anna Koerner, 2326 Louisiana Street, Little Rock, Arkansas 72206 |
| CALIFORNIA | (23) Southern - David Hall, 309 S. Alexandria Avenue, Los Angeles, California 90020 |
| | (23) Northern Coastal - Merle Garth, 350 Laurel Avenue, Millbrae, California 94030 |
| | (22) Northern Interior - Bob Bernelle, 3701 Irish Road, Redding, California 96001 |
| | (22) San Diego - Charles Barlow, 1820 Denver Street, San Diego, California 92110 |
| | (22) Mid-Southern - John McAneny, 9601 El Rey Avenue, Apt. 23, Fountain Valley, California 92708 |
| COLORADO | (23) Don Pross, 1436 Williams, Apt. 204, Denver, Colorado 80218 |
| CONNECTICUT | (23) John Collins, 868 Mill Plain Road, Fairfield, Connecticut 06430 |
| DELAWARE | (22) Carl D. Kumpf, 917 Washington Street, Wilmington, Delaware 19801 |
| D.C. | (23) John Waterfield, 2900 Adams Hill Road N.W., Washington, D.C. 20009 |
| FLORIDA | (23) Northern - Bill Pratt, 320 Newburyport Avenue, Altamonte Springs, Florida 32701 |
| | (23) Southern - Brick Barron, 3414 W. Louisiana, Tampa, Florida 33614 |
| GEORGIA | (22) John Deal, 333 Jewel Drive, Statesboro, Georgia 30458 |
| HAWAII | (23) H. J. (Pete) Peterson, 2959 Kalakaua Avenue, #611, Honolulu, Hawaii 96815 |
| IDAHO | (22) Ted Bowen, Box 3, Malad, Idaho 83252 |

Conference Area Delegates

ROSTER

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
ILLINOIS	(23) Chicago – Norm Adams, 3310 Grant, Evanston, Illinois 60201	MONTANA	(22) Robert (Pablo Bob) Steilen, Box 121, Pablo, Montana 59855
	(22) Northern – Louis W. Dietrich, Box 591, Glen Ellyn, Illinois 60137	NEBRASKA	(22) Doug Mills, Jr., Route #1, Ansley, Nebraska 68814
	(23) Southern – Chuck Lowry, 233 S. Thorncrest, Creve Coeur, Illinois	NEVADA	(23) Bob Horrigan, 1621 "C" Street, Sparks, Nevada 89431
INDIANA	(23) Northern – Jim Shell, 3512 Harvester Avenue, Fort Wayne, Indiana 46803	NEW HAMPSHIRE	(22) Gordon Brooks, 18 Briar Road, Bedford, New Hampshire 03102
	(22) Southern – Don Owens, 2201 S. 8th Street, Terre Haute, Indiana 47802	NEW JERSEY	(23) Northern – Marge Raven, 278 Parker Avenue, Hackensack, New Jersey 07602
IOWA	(23) Laurence (Van) Van Note, Route 1, Blairs Ferry Road, Marion, Iowa 52302		(22) *Southern – Noel LeClair, 157 Cooper Avenue, Woodlynne, New Jersey 08107
KANSAS	(22) Ben Parr, Route 1, Pratt, Kansas 67124	NEW MEXICO	(22) James (Jim) O'Neill, P.O. Box 154, Farmington, New Mexico 87401
KENTUCKY	(22) Criss B. Richards, 7816 Dixie Highway, Florence, Kentucky 41042	NEW YORK	(23) Central – Lawrence (Larry) Jewell, 171 Robinson Street, Binghamton, New York 13904
LOUISIANA	(23) Travis Howard, 100 Rogers Road, West Monroe, Louisiana 71281		(22) Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire – Mary Tomlinson, P.O. Box 23, Monroe Bridge, Massachusetts 01350
MAINE	(22) Roland (Rolly) Rivard, P.O. Box 419, 5 Fontaine Avenue, Rumford, Maine 04276		(23) Southeastern – Ruth K. Hartshorn, 190-18 89th Avenue, Hollis, New York 11423
MARYLAND	(22) William Clapp, 106 Lorraine Terrace, Hagerstown, Maryland 21740		(22) Western – Ralph Zimmerman, 5239 River Road, Niagara Falls, Ontario, Canada
MASSACHUSETTS	(23) Eastern – Donald Santry, 99 Pioneer Avenue, Brockton, Massachusetts 02401		(23) Zeb Mauney, P.O. Box 306, Newport, North Carolina 28570
	(22) Western – Richard Driscoll, 129 Rhinebeck Avenue, Springfield, Massachusetts 01129	NORTH CAROLINA	
MICHIGAN	(23) Central – William H. Hamlin, 1410 W. Jackson Avenue, Flint, Michigan 48504	NORTH DAKOTA	(22) *Fred Blair, 2515 S. 10, Grand Forks, North Dakota 58201
	(23) Southeast – William (Gus) A. Jenkins, 11011 Hudson Street, Warren, Michigan 48089	OHIO	(23) Central & Southeast – Lowell E. Beaty, 129 West North Street, Worthington, Ohio 43085
	(22) *Western – Peter Slager, Box 211, Montague, Michigan 49437		(23) Northeast – John Baker, 23747 Vincent Drive, North Olmstead, Ohio 44070
MINNESOTA	(22) Northern – Frank Juola, 312 16th Street, Cloquet, Minnesota 55720		(22) N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan – Chuck Webb, 4030 W. Bancroft Street, Toledo, Ohio 43606
	(23) Southern – Earl Lietzau, 520 S. Jefferson, New Ulm, Minnesota 56073		(22) So. Southwest Ohio/Northern Kentucky – Ken Wilderson, 4051 Plover, Hamilton, Ohio 45014
MISSISSIPPI	(22) Henry Watson, Box 46, Aberdeen, Mississippi 39730	OKLAHOMA	(23) Wilson F. Pruitt, 721 N.W. 15th Street, Oklahoma City, Oklahoma 73103
MISSOURI	(23) Eastern – Paul Cavanaugh, 201 Pralle Lane, St. Charles, Missouri 63301	OREGON	(22) Chester (Chet) Carlson, 23349 S. Molalla Avenue, Oregon City, Oregon 97045
	(23) Western – Lucille Thompson, 108 W. 6th, Route #1, Urich, Missouri 64788		*ALTERNATE DELEGATES

ROSTER**Delegates, cont'd**

STATE	PANEL	CANADA	PANEL
PENNSYLVANIA	(23) Eastern – Joseph De Beaumont, 1736 Prospect Avenue, Croydon, Pennsylvania 19020	PROVINCE	
	(23) Western – Francis Flack, 1426 Wakefield Drive, Sharpsville, Pennsylvania 16150	ALBERTA	(22) *Bill Leicht, Box 474, Innisfail, Alberta, Canada
RHODE ISLAND	(22) Swan Johnson, 158 Massasoit Drive, Warwick, Rhode Island 02888	BRITISH COLUMBIA/ YUKON	(23) A. G. Bennett, 2498 Beaufort Road, Sidney, British Columbia, Canada
SOUTH CAROLINA	(22) Lloyd Gardner, 143 Cleveland Park Drive, Spartanburg, South Carolina 29302	MANITOBA	(22) Bill Heatley, 49-50 Prevette Place, Winnipeg 15, Manitoba, Canada R2K 3E3
SOUTH DAKOTA	(22) Marvin Barkley, 717 North, Watertown, South Dakota 57201	NEW BRUNSWICK/ PRINCE EDWARD ISLAND	(22) Bob Gay, 30 Maple Grove Village, Joyce Avenue, Moncton, New Brunswick, Canada
TENNESSEE	(22) Earl Lindsey, 3775 Westview Drive, Cleveland, Tennessee 37311	NOVA SCOTIA/NEW- FOUNDLAND/ LABRADOR	(23) Alister (Al) MacRae, Box 1043, Sidney, Nova Scotia, Canada
TEXAS	(23) Northeast – Patrick Mullarkey, 3138 Valley Meadow #151, Dallas, Texas 75220	ONTARIO	(23) Eastern – Charles Parks, 711 Jefferson Avenue, Ogdensburg, New York 13669
	(22) Northwest – LaVelle Clifford, 200 Shadow Mountain Drive, #97, El Paso, Texas 79912		(23) Northeastern – Bob Fournier, 45 Pepper Tree Court, Sudbury, Ontario, Canada
	(23) Southeast – Don Angelloz, 4145 Casan, Houston, Texas 77005		(23) Northwestern – Murray Slater, 535 S. Vickers Street, Thunder Bay, Ontario, Canada
	(22) Southwest – Elves Smith, Route 12, Box 279, San Antonio, Texas 78221		(22) Western – G. A. (Al) Burns, 969 Glenview Avenue, Burlington, Ontario, Canada
UTAH	(23) Jack Chapman, 2277 Logan Avenue, Salt Lake City, Utah 84108	QUEBEC	(22) Southwestern – English – Sheila Martin, 8 Church Street, Point Claire, Quebec, Canada
VERMONT	(22) Howard Shortsleeves, 72 Pine Street, Rutland, Vermont 05701		(22) Southwestern – French – Elmer Signori, 8357 Rameau, Montreal 429, Quebec, Canada
VIRGINIA	(23) Fred M. Calvert, 1013 Five Forks Road, Virginia Beach, Virginia 23455		(23) Northeastern – Marcel Lainesse, 32 Notre Dame Street, Arthabaska, Quebec, Canada
WASHINGTON	(23) Ted Knightlinger, 2501 N. Junette, Tacoma, Washington 98406	SASKATCHEWAN	(22) George Derksen, 820 Hastings Place, Estevan, Saskatchewan, Canada
WEST VIRGINIA	(23) George Ellison, 6 Granview Drive, Charleston, West Virginia 23502		*ALTERNATE DELEGATE
WISCONSIN	(22) No. Wisconsin/Upper Michigan – Wilbert (Bert) Laaninen, Route 1, Box 84B, Republic, Michigan 49879		
	(23) Southern – Virginia Hallman, 4304 North Alpine Avenue, Shorewood, Wisconsin 53211		
WYOMING	(22) Starr Masson, Box 364, Sinclair, Wyoming 82334		
PUERTO RICO	(22) Zandos Rodriguez, W-H-18, URB, Los Angeles, Loiza Sta., Santurce, Puerto Rico 00913		



ELECTORAL MAP OF U.S. & CANADA